

“STUDIED FOR ACTION”: HOW GABRIEL HARVEY READ HIS LIVY

I

PROLOGUE: “THE ACTIVITY OF READING”

This essay forms part of a larger, book-length project, which is intended to contribute to the historical understanding of the ways in which humanistically trained readers assimilated and responded to the classical heritage.¹ But it seeks to go beyond the traditional, textual definition of this field to reconstruct the social, professional and personal contexts in which reading took place.² Although the present study deals with a topic historians tend to label as “high culture”, it will be clear that we also intend it to be in dialogue with a body of recent publications on the history of reading and of the book. That work, although by no means homogeneous, broadly concerns itself with the production and circulation of printed texts, and with setting the activity of reading in its historical and cultural contexts, as well as with some of the social implications that result from a particular locating of reading in history.

All historians of early modern culture now acknowledge that early modern readers did not passively receive but rather actively reinterpreted their texts, and so do we. But we intend to take that notion of *activity* in a strong sense: not just the energy which must be acknowledged as accompanying the intervention of the scholar/reader with his text, nor the cerebral effort involved in making the text the reader's own, but reading as intended to *give rise to something else*. We argue that scholarly reading (the kind of reading we are concerned with here) was always goal-orientated — an active, rather than a passive pursuit. It was conducted under conditions of strenuous attentiveness; it employed job-related equipment (both machinery

¹ A. Grafton, L. Jardine and W. Sherman, *Reading in the Renaissance* (provisional title).

² Although the project is a significantly new one, treating Renaissance texts as the basis for transactions among designated groups of readers, we recognize that individual studies of humanistic influence provide important precedents for our own work. See, for example, M. Lowry, “The Arrival and Use of Continental Printed Books in Yorkist England”, in P. Aquilon and H.-J. Martin (eds.), *Le livre dans l'Europe de la Renaissance: actes du XXVIII^e colloque international d'études humanistes de Tours* (Paris, 1988), pp. 447-59, at pp. 456-7. We are grateful to Warren Boutcher of Trinity Hall, Cambridge, for this reference.

and techniques) designed for efficient absorption and processing of the matter read; it was normally carried out in the company of a colleague or student; and was a public performance, rather than a private meditation, in its aims and character.³

Above all, as we shall see, this "activity of reading" characteristically envisaged some other outcome of reading beyond accumulation of information; and that envisaged outcome then shaped the relationship between reader and text. In consequence, a single text could give rise to a variety of goal-directed readings, depending on the initial brief.⁴ Inevitably this has consequences for specific readings of given texts by a reader briefed (by himself or others) in particular ways, which mean that the modern historian cannot afford to prejudge what will constitute its focus or central theme. Indeed, we would argue that, if we use our own understanding of the salient features of the text of Livy (say) to identify the points of crucial importance to an Elizabethan reader, we are very likely to miss or to confuse the methods and objects at which reading was directed.

We believe that our study will significantly enrich what has recently come to be called "the history of reading". Students of this burgeon-

³ See, for example, a suggestive passage in Henry Wotton's commonplace-book: "In reading of history, a soldier should draw the platform of battles he meets with, plant the squadrons and order the whole frame as he finds it written, so he shall print it firmly in his mind and apt his mind for actions. A politique should find the characters of personages and apply them to some of the Court he lives in, which will likewise confirm his memory and give scope and matter for conjecture and invention. A friend to confer readings together most necessary": L. P. Smith, *The Life and Letters of Sir Henry Wotton*, 2 vols. (Oxford, 1907), ii, p. 494.

⁴ A fine example of this is the reading which John Dee offered Sir Edward Dyer, in 1597, of Dee's own *General and Rare Memorials Pertayning to the Perfect Arte of Navigation* of twenty years earlier (1577). Dyer had written requesting Dee's advice on "Her Ma.^{ties} Title Royall and Sea Sovereignty in S^t Georges Chanell; and in all the Brytish Ocean; any man[er] of way next envyrioninge, or next adioynng vnto, England, Ireland and Scotland, or any of the lesser Iles to them apperteyning": British Lib., London (hereafter Brit. Lib.), Harleian MS. 249, fos. 95-105, at fo. 95. What Dee gives Dyer is a route through *General and Rare Memorials* which will yield a "reading" which answers his question, and he does this with great textual precision: "In the 20th page of that booke, (against the figure, 9 in the margent) begynneth matter, inducing the consideration of her Ma.^{ties} Royall Sealimits, and her peculiar Iurisdiction, in all the Seas, next, vnto her Ma.^{ties} kingdomes, dominions and Territories. {Note this worde, NEXT for it will haue diuerse vses in the Consideration, De Confinio in Mari statuendo, vt in Terra} And here vpon, in the 21 page, both in the Text, and also in the Margent, is pregnant matter conteyned: and the same confirmed by the lawes Ciuile: and the great Ciuillien doctors Iudgm[en]t, there alledged" etc. (*ibid.*). William Sherman is currently working in the Cambridge University English Faculty on this and other of Dee's manuscript writings, in the context of Dee's own role as a political facilitator (or "intelligencer", as Sherman prefers to term him). This work will form part of our collaborative book, *Reading in the Renaissance*.

ing discipline, above all Robert Darnton and Roger Chartier, have done much to focus scholars' attention on the process of reading and the ways in which this has changed over time. They have shown that factors as diverse as the typographical layout of a text, the physical circumstances under which it is read and the process by which the reader obtains it have a powerful effect on the reader's experience of the text itself. They have turned up rich information about authors' and readers' expectations within early modern novels and treatises. They have sometimes been able to discover readers in the process of response, explaining to booksellers or authors themselves exactly how they were struck by a given text.⁵ But this new historiography has yet to show an interest in the kind of material we tackle here.

One reason for this may be that the transactional model of reading which we use assumes that a single text may give rise to a plurality of possible responses, not a tidily univocal interpretation. Historians of reading have been inclined to settle for rather simple models for the reading practices of definable social groups and to locate sharp moments of transition when one set of practices yields to another: when reading passes from speech to silence, from public to private settings, from intensive to extensive or passive to active. But, even in the realm of popular culture, a variety of kinds of reading were understood to take place, and such readings were not sealed off from more "serious" and "educated" encounters with the written word.⁶ Aspects of the leisured reading of the élite and of the urban consumption of *bibliothèque bleue* volumes undoubtedly also shape the reading which takes place in the scholarly study or the university classroom.⁷

What we attempt here is to show one kind of purposeful reading in process. We have chosen to focus on directed reading conducted in the circle (and under the auspices) of prominent Elizabethan political figures, because we ourselves find the interaction between

⁵ See, for example, R. C. Darnton, "Readers Respond to Rousseau", in his *The Great Cat Massacre and Other Episodes in French Cultural History* (New York, 1984); R. Chartier, *The Cultural Uses of Print in Early Modern Europe*, trans. L. G. Cochrane (Princeton, 1987). A classic study of reading by someone not primarily identified as a student of this field is C. Ginzburg, *The Cheese and the Worms*, trans. J. and A. Tedeschi (Baltimore, 1980).

⁶ As symptoms of the plurality of possibilities for the use of texts at a specified historical moment, see the preface to John Lyly, *Euphues* (London, 1578); introductory epistle to Thomas Nashe, *The Unfortunate Traveller* (London, 1594); preface to Ben Jonson, *Bartholomew Fair* (London, 1631).

⁷ Chartier, *Cultural Uses of Print*, ch. 5, "Publishing Strategies and What the People Read, 1530-1660", ch. 7, "The *Bibliothèque bleue* and Popular Reading"; R. Chartier, "Texts, Printing, Readings", in L. Hunt (ed.), *The New Cultural History* (Berkeley, 1989), pp. 154-75.

politics and scholarship here particularly exciting for the light it can cast *both* on political affiliation (who shared what political beliefs) *and* on the activity of the scholars these figures retained more or less formally in their service. At one level, of course, the discovery of close connections between political theory as contained in classical texts and Tudor political practice is not unexpected; it is the *nature* of the connection which is surprising (its methodical character, its persistence as an emphasis in scholarly reading, the seriousness with which "reading" was treated by those active in the political arena). Elsewhere, in work we are currently engaged in on other readings in other contexts (medical, astronomical, philosophical and dialectical), where the modern reader is less prepared for it, we are finding equally unexpected, related conjunctions of reading practice and application to specified goals.

II

"A WORD WILL SUFFICE FOR THE WISE": SCHOLARS AND MARTIALISTS

On 18 February 1601 Sir Thomas Arundel wrote a letter to Sir Robert Cecil, defending himself against any implication in the Essex rising, and urging clemency for the earl of Southampton.⁸ With this letter was enclosed an unsigned paper in the same hand, which contains the following passage:

I can not but wrighte what I think may avayle you so dothe my love manyfest my follye. Theare is one Cuff a certayne purytane skoller one of the whottest heades of my lo: of Essex his followers. This Cuff was sente by my lo: of Essex to reade to my lo: of Southampton in Paris where hee redd Aristotles polyticks to hym wth sutch exposytions as, I doubt, did hym but lyttle good: afterwards hee redd to my lo: of Rutlande. I protest I owe hym no mallyce, but yf hee showd [?] faultye heerein, w^{ch} I greatlye doubt, I can not but wish his punishment. [In Latin] A word will suffice for the wise (*verbum sapienti*).⁹

Henry Cuffe, one-time professor of Greek at Oxford, and secretary to the earl of Essex, had as one of his duties (according to Arundel)

⁸ Bodleian Lib., Oxford, Ashmolean MS. 1729, fo. 189, Sir Thomas Arundel to Sir Robert Cecil, 18 Feb. 1601. We are extremely grateful to Paul Hammer for bringing this letter and its enclosure to our attention, and for his unerring ability, in the course of his own work, to pick up from the political correspondence of the 1590s items which confirm our intuitions about the relationship in that period between "arms and letters".

⁹ *Ibid.*, fo. 190. In a personal communication, 21 July 1989, Paul Hammer comments: "In enclosing this note on a separate piece of paper and unsigned, it seems very probable Arundel was following a common procedure for dealing with sensitive information".

that of professional reader: "to reade to my lo: of Southampton", and to provide his own expositions of the text (Aristotle's *Politics*).¹⁰ The note suggests that there was a specific category of employee in a noble household such as Essex's: the scholar, retained to "read" with his employer and his employer's associates. And there is a strong suggestion that this reading is politically aware, that it serves a political purpose, of which the scholar/secretary is apprised, and in which he is actively involved ("hee redd Aristotles polyticks to hym wth sutch exposytions as, I doubt, did hym [Southampton] but lyttle good"). This might lead us to reassess the accusation levelled at Cuffe by Essex after his arrest (according to Camden; proof, according to Mervyn James, of Essex's violation of "all the canons of honour"): "you were the principal man that moved me to this perfidiousness".¹¹ Was it to Cuffe's line in "exposytions" that Essex was attributing blame, on the grounds that these had led him to believe that his political activities were sanctioned by the authority of classical political texts?¹²

A second letter from the Essex circle further supports the idea of scholar-secretaries employed for "reading" — providing interpretations of textual material on pragmatic political themes. An undated letter to Fulke Greville, attributed to Essex, advises Greville as follows:

¹⁰ Henry Cuffe was in the end hanged for his part in the abortive rebellion (Southampton got life imprisonment). Here, however, we set on one side the emotive "conspiracy" testimonies of the state papers and Camden's *Annales*, and concentrate on Cuffe's *profession*. The state papers (but not Camden) contain a version of Cuffe's scaffold speech which is entirely appropriate to the profession of scholar in service to the man of arms: "Schollars and Martiallists (thoughe learning and vallour should have the p[re]hemynence yet) in England must dye like dogges and be hanged: To mislike this, were but folly; to dispute of it, but tyme lost; to alter it impossible; but to endure it manlye, and to scorne it magnanimitye": Public Record Office, London (hereafter P.R.O.), SP12/279, no. 26. See also the document containing Cuffe's final confession, in which he tried to maintain a distinction between the guidance he gave on policy (which he admitted) and the use to which that advice was put (for which, he tried to maintain, he could not be held responsible). The document records, "My Lord Graye saide, this is no time for Logicke": P.R.O., SP12/279, no. 25.

¹¹ William Camden, *Historie of Elizabeth Queene of England* (London, 1630), p. 187; cited in Mervyn James, *Society, Politics and Culture: Studies in Early Modern England* (Cambridge, 1986), p. 458: "Particularly discreditable was his betrayal of a dependant, his secretary Henry Cuffe, and his ascription to him of such a high politic act as his revolt, which his status required him to take upon himself. When the earl taxed Cuffe that 'you were the principal man that moved me to this perfidiousness', the latter in his turn 'taxed briefly and sharply the earl's inconstancy, in that he betrayed those most devoted to him'".

¹² See also Henry Wotton, *Of Robert Devereux, Earl of Essex: And George Villiers, Duke of Buckingham: Some Observations by Way of Parallel, in the Time of their Estates of Favour*, ed. Sir Egerton Brydges (priv. pr., Lee Priory, Kent, 1816), pp. 32-4.

Cosin Foulke: you tell me you are going to Cambridge and that the Ends of yo^r going are, to get a Scholar to yo^r liking, to lue wth you, and some 2, or 3 others to remain in the Uniuersitie, and gather for you; and you require my Opinion, what Instruction, you shall giue those Gatherers. to w^{ch} I will, more out of Affection for yo^r Satisfaction, to do what I can, then out of Confidence that I can doo any thing: and though you get nothing ells by this idle discourse; yet you shall learn this, that, if you will haue yo^r Friend pe[r]form what you require, you must require nothing about his Strength. Hee that shall out of his own Reading gather for the use of another, must (as I think) do it by Epitome, or Abridgment, or under Heads, and common places.¹³

In our earlier work on humanist education we noted, tentatively, that some humanist teachers suggested that a nobleman or prince might employ a poor but gifted young man to read and excerpt the classics for him. Here we suggest that some Elizabethan great houses supported a recognizable class of scholar who performed exactly this function, acting less as advisers in the modern sense than as facilitators easing the difficult negotiations between modern needs and ancient texts. Such readers read, either alone or in company, on their employers' rather than on their own behalf, for purposes and with methods that varied dramatically from occasion to occasion. We propose to show how one such individual actually used his skills to derive counsel from the texts. Our facilitator is Gabriel Harvey; his employment was in the household of the earl of Leicester.¹⁴

III

READING "IN THE TRADE OF OUR LIVES": THE PHILIP SIDNEY READING

Gabriel Harvey was born in 1550 of a prominent Saffron Walden burgher family, and died there a highly respected local public figure in 1630. He took his B.A. at Christ's College, Cambridge, in 1569-70, was a fellow of first Pembroke Hall (where he took his M.A., against some internal college opposition), and then Trinity Hall (of which he made an unsuccessful attempt to become master). He occupied a number of university posts, including university praelector of rhetoric (1573-5) and university proctor (1583). He obtained his LL.B. in 1584, and was incepted Doctor of Civil Law at Oxford in 1585. In the late 1580s he practised in the Court of Arches in London.

¹³ Bodleian Lib., Tanner MS. 79, fos. 29^r-30^r. We are grateful to Paul Hammer for this reference also, and to William Sherman for making a preliminary transcription for us. The remainder of the letter details methods for making epitomes and commonplace collections, and the kinds of work usefully to be epitomized.

¹⁴ We owe the term "facilitator" here to Rachel Weil of the University of Georgia.

He held a secretarial post with the earl of Leicester briefly in 1580, and appears to have had other official connections with members of the court circle (in particular members of the so-called "war party" — Low Church opponents of Elizabeth's policy of political appeasement in Europe). He published both "high" educational works, and popular works (including several exchanges of letters with his friend Edmund Spenser, and some "low" pamphlet material). His publishing career was terminated after a rancorous series of pamphlet exchanges with Thomas Nashe, at the end of which, in 1599, both men's works were banned from publication.¹⁵

Harvey's *Livy* is a grand and heavy folio in sixes, printed in Basle in 1555.¹⁶ In this edition, the text of *Livy* appears flanked by both critics and supporters. Two elaborate commentaries, one by Ioannes Velcurio and one by Henricus Glareanus, follow the text and explicate it, often phrase by phrase. Instructions for reading history, by Simon Grynaeus, precede it. Lorenzo Valla's iconoclastic demonstration that *Livy* had committed a genealogical error also appears, lest the reader feel more reverence than a Roman classic properly demands. The entire book is densely annotated by Harvey, indicating successive readings over a period of more than twenty years.¹⁷

At the end of book three of the first decade of Harvey's *Livy* there is the following note:

The courtier Philip Sidney and I had privately discussed these three books of *Livy*, scrutinizing them so far as we could from all points of view, applying a political analysis, just before his embassy to the emperor Rudolf II. He went to offer him congratulations in the queen's name just after he had been made emperor. Our consideration was chiefly directed at the forms of states, the conditions of persons, and the qualities of actions. We paid little attention to the annotations of Glareanus and others.¹⁸

¹⁵ This summary is based on V. F. Stern, *Gabriel Harvey: His Life, Marginalia and Library* (Oxford, 1979); G. C. Moore Smith, *Gabriel Harvey's Marginalia* (Stratford-upon-Avon, 1913). For some recent remarks on Harvey's relationship with Andrew Perne at Cambridge, see Patrick Collinson, "Andrew Perne and his Times" (unpublished paper).

¹⁶ Princeton University Lib., Deposit of Lucius Wilmerding Jr., *T. Livii Patavini, Romanae historiae principis, decades tres, cum dimidia* (Basle, 1555) (hereafter Harvey's *Livy*). The volume is inscribed "ex dono Dⁿⁱ Henrici Harveij. A. 1568", and contains notes made during the period 1568-90. We are extremely grateful to the owner and to Princeton University Library for allowing us access to this volume.

¹⁷ On Harvey's habits of annotating, see Moore Smith, *Gabriel Harvey's Marginalia*; C. Brown Bourland, "Gabriel Harvey and the Modern Languages", *Huntington Lib. Quart.*, iv (1940-1), pp. 85-106; H. S. Wilson, "Gabriel Harvey's Method of Annotating his Books", *Huntington Lib. Bull.*, ii (1948), pp. 344-61; J.-C. Margolin, "Gabriel Harvey, lecteur d'Erasmé", *Arquivos do Centro Cultural Portugues*, iv (1972), pp. 37-92; Stern, *Gabriel Harvey* (and her bibliography, *ibid.*, p. 272-3).

¹⁸ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 93. In all instances where excerpts from Harvey's marginalia are given in modern English this indicates that the original annotation was in Latin.

Here is an extremely precise reference. Just these three books, read through by Harvey and Sidney, *tête-à-tête*, with an eye to political analysis, and "shortly before his embassy to Emperor Rudolph II". They were particularly interested in types of republic, in the protagonists' character and circumstances, and in the types of action. They deliberately ignored — as men of action perhaps should — the humanist commentaries.

In October 1576 Sidney returned from Ireland, probably escorting the body of the earl of Essex, who had died there on 22 September.¹⁹ While in Ireland he had accompanied his father, Sir Henry Sidney (governor-general in Ireland), with the task of dealing (apparently pretty unsuccessfully) with bands of rebels.

This was Sidney's first active service. He set out on his embassy to Rudolph in February 1577. Between Ireland and this first diplomatic service Sidney was in England; he visited John Dee on 16 January 1577 and sent a letter from Leicester House on 8 February.²⁰ It seems reasonable to infer that he and Harvey read Livy at Leicester House between October 1576 and February 1577.²¹

In book one of the third decade Harvey once again links a "reading" of Livy with members of Sidney's circle or associates.²²

¹⁹ See H. Hore, "Sir Henry Sidney's Memoir of his Government", *Ulster Jl. Archaeol.*, v (1857), pp. 299-323: "Here [Galway] heard we first of the extreame and hopelesse sickness of the earl of Essex, by whom Sir Philip being often most lovingly and earnestly wished and written for, he with all the speed he could make went to him, but found him dead before his coming, in the castle at Dublin" (p. 314). We are grateful to William Maley for this reference.

²⁰ The Dee visit included Leicester, Philip Sidney and "the latter's close friend, Edward Dyer": J. M. Osborn, *Young Philip Sidney, 1572-1577* (New Haven and London, 1972), pp. 449, 451.

²¹ An additional clue is that on sig. Fii^r of Gabriel Harvey, *Gratulationes Valdenses* (London, 1578), "a poem is described as having been presented to Leicester in 1576": Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 39. There is one further piece of tantalizing circumstantial evidence suggesting that Harvey may have been in some way associated with Sidney even earlier. In Osborn, *Young Philip Sidney*, pp. 402-3, there is a series of three letters from the biographer of Ramus, Théophile de Banos, concerning his edition of Ramus's *Commentaries*, preceded by a biography of Ramus, which the printer Wechel (also a friend of Sidney's) had just produced. The first letter promises that: "if I cannot find a friend to take them [Ramus's *Commentaries*], I will send a man specially to Master Harvey in Antwerp, so that you will safely receive them". "Master Harvey" must have been returning to England, thus a carrier for the book. In the event, de Banos sends two further anxious letters, because the book has apparently not arrived, and in March he receives word from Sidney that he has still not received it: *ibid.*, pp. 408-9, 416-17. From January until the beginning of the Cambridge Easter term (April?), Harvey was inexplicably out of Cambridge, and nothing is known of his whereabouts: Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 30-1. Harvey was a dedicated Ramist, and in any case the Sidney/Ramus/Wechel connection — Sidney exchanges letters with Wechel authorizing him to buy him the latest books at the Frankfurt book fair, for which he will reimburse him — is intriguing.

²² On fo. 53^r of Brit. Lib., Sloane MS. 93 (the so-called Harvey letter-book),

Each decade is fine, but this one should be studied by the best actors. The quality of the content, and its great power; where the virtue of the Romans suffers so much. Certainly some light can be shed by Louis le Roy's Commentaries on Aristotle's Politics; Bodin's Republic and Methodus; du Poncet's Turkish Secrets in the Gallic Court; Sansovino's Political Maxims; the recent works on politics by Althusius and Lipsius; a few others. And it is fitting for prudent men to make strenuous efforts to use whatever sheds light on politics: and to increase it as much as they can. Two outstanding courtiers thanked me for this political and historical inquiry: Sir Edward Dyer and Sir Edward Denny. But let the project itself — once fully tried — be my reward. All I want is a lively and effective political analysis of the chief histories: especially when Hannibal and Scipio, Marius and Sylla, Pompey and Caesar flourished.²³

Other evidence complements these notes, enabling us to reconstruct Harvey's role in full. In Harvey's Sacrobosco (now in the British Library), which carries the inscription "Arte, et virtute, 1580" on its title-page,²⁴ a note on sig. aii^r reads: "Sacrobosco & Valerius, Sir Philip Sidneis two bookes for the Spheare. Bie him specially commended to the Earl of Essex, Sir Edward Dennie, & divers gentlemen of the Court. To be read with diligent studie, but sportingly, as he termed it".²⁵

So Sidney, by 1580, apparently had his own views on "reading" for those in the political arena. Or did he? Osborn prints a letter from Sidney to Edward Denny which came to light in a "near-contemporary transcript" in 1971. It is dated 22 May 1580, on the eve of Denny's departure (like Spenser) in the train of Lord Grey, the new governor of Ireland, appointed to put down Irish disturbances more single-mindedly than had Henry Sidney.²⁶ It apparently answers an inquiry from Denny as to what he should read to improve his mind (and presumably his prospects), and is something of a set piece. It also makes clear, as Sidney does elsewhere in his letters, that in the face of Elizabeth's determined resistance to military engagement

(n. 22 cont.)

somewhat cryptically inserted in the narrative, is a fragment of a letter from "Immerito" (Spenser) at court which reads: "The two worthy gentlemen, Mr. Sidney and Mr. Dyer, have me, I thanke them, in sum use of familiaritye; of whom and to whome what speache passith for your creddeite and estimation, I leave yourselfe to conceyve, havinge allwayes so well conceyvid of my unfainid affection and good will towardes yow. And nowe they have proclaymid in there ἀφειωπαγω". Stern mistakenly makes this a letter from Harvey: Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 39.

²³ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 277.

²⁴ Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 233-4.

²⁵ Transcribed *ibid.*, p. 79.

²⁶ See L. Jardine, "'Mastering the Uncouth': Gabriel Harvey, Edmund Spenser and the English Experience in Ireland", in J. Henry and S. Hutton (eds.), *New Perspectives on Renaissance Thought: Essays in the History of Science, Education and Philosophy in Memory of C. B. Schmitt* (London, 1990), pp. 68-82.

aspiring men of action like himself and Denny have a good deal of time on their hands, and that "reading" and "study" are the approved, character-forming way of relieving boredom:

You will me to tell you my minde of the directinge your studyes. I will doe it as well as the hast of your boy [the waiting messenger], and my little iudgement will habile me. But first let me reioyse with you, th' since the vnnoble constitution of our tyme, doth keepe vs from fitte imployments, you doe yet keepe your selfe awake, w^t the delight of knowledge.²⁷

For the foundation of study Sidney naturally prescribes scriptural reading. But when he comes to "the trade of our lives", he specifies reading which is (we would argue) quite clearly based on that "reading" with Gabriel Harvey three years earlier:

The second parte consists as it were in the trade of our lives. For a physician must study one thinge, and a Lawyer an other, but to you th' with good reason bend your selfe to souldiery, what bookes can deliver, stands in the books th' profess the arte, & in historyes. The first shewes what should be done, and the other what hath bene done. Of the first sorte is *Langeai* in french, and *Machiavell* in Italian, and many other wherof I will not take vpon me to iudge, but this I thinke if you will study them, it shall be necessary for you to exercise your hande in setting downe what you reed, as in descriptions of battaillons, camps, and marches, with some practise of Arithmetike, which sportingly you may exercise. Of them I will say noe further, for I am witness of myne owne ignoraunce. For historicall maters, I wouold wish you before you began to reed a litle of *Sacroboscos Sphaere*, & the *Geography* of some moderne writer, wherof there are many & is a very easy and delightful study. You have already very good iudgement of the *Sea mappes*, which will make the other much easier; and provide your selfe of an *Ortelius*, th' when you reed of any place, you may finde it out, & have it, as it were before your eyes.²⁸

"Some practise of Arithmetike, which sportingly you may exercise" — echoed in Harvey's "To be read with diligent studie, but sportingly, as [Sidney] termed it" in his copy of *Sacrobosco* — indicates that Harvey saw this letter (it is even possible he wrote it).²⁹ It seems clear to us that we do indeed have here an agreed "reading" of history, for the "trade of our lives" — politics and "souldiery". And the source of that reading, since, as we shall see, the copiousness and consistency of Harvey's annotations must establish him as its originating influence, is that "armchair" politician (as he used to be characterized) Gabriel Harvey.

We begin here because the Denny letter/Harvey marginalia connection establishes at the outset some real-life events and outcomes for

²⁷ Osborn, *Young Philip Sidney*, appendix 5, pp. 535-40, at p. 537.

²⁸ *Ibid.*, p. 539.

²⁹ Or Spenser, with Denny in Ireland, saw it. At any rate, there is a direct connection between Harvey and the letter.

Harvey's reading of Livy. It will be an important part of our argument to maintain that Renaissance readers (and annotators) persistently envisage action as the *outcome* of reading — not simply reading as active, but reading as trigger for action. Here we may note how the chance opportunity to collate the marginal notes of an individual known only as a reader (and thus labelled politically non-participant by later scholars) with a "letter of advice" from an individual known to be politically and diplomatically active seems to sharpen up "reading" into potential "advice", and provide a link between the absorption of information (as we would tend to judge reading) and public practice.

IV

"I RAN OVER THIS DECADE ON HANNIBAL IN A WEEK": THE COLONEL THOMAS SMITH READING

At the bottom of page 428 of the Livy Harvey records a debate he participated in at Hill House, Theydon Mount, home of his patron Sir Thomas Smith, in which Livy's historical commentary stimulated a lively topical discussion of Elizabethan military strategy:

Thomas Smith junior and Sir Humphrey Gilbert [debated] for Marcellus, Thomas Smith senior and Doctor Walter Haddon for Fabius Maximus, before an audience at Hill Hall consisting at that very time of myself, John Wood, and several others of gentle birth. At length the son and Sir Humphrey yielded to the distinguished secretary: perhaps Marcellus yielded to Fabius. Both of them worthy men, and judicious. Marcellus the more powerful; Fabius the more cunning. Neither was the latter unprepared [weak], nor the former imprudent: each as indispensable as the other in his place. There are times when I would rather be Marcellus, times when Fabius.

We can date the event to which this note refers with some accuracy. Between 1566 and 1570 Sir Humphrey Gilbert was on active service in Ireland.³⁰ He was knighted for his services on 1 January 1570, and returned to England at the end of that month, remaining there until July 1572, when he was sent to the Netherlands against the Spanish.³¹ From summer 1571 he was certainly involved with Sir Thomas Smith in a speculative project to obtain a monopoly on a supposed procedure for transmuting iron into copper.³² Sir Thomas Smith was in France

³⁰ D. B. Quinn, *The Voyages and Colonising Enterprises of Sir Humphrey Gilbert*, 2 vols. (London, 1940), i, p. 12.

³¹ *Ibid.*, i, pp. 17-18, 22-3.

³² M. Dewar, *Sir Thomas Smith: A Tudor Intellectual in Office* (London, 1964), pp. 149-55; Quinn, *Voyages and Colonising Enterprises of Sir Humphrey Gilbert*, i, pp. 20-1.

from December 1571.³³ Harvey knew John Wood in 1569, when he noted in his copy of Smith's *De recta et emendata linguae anglicae scriptione dialogus* (London, 1567), that the book was a gift from Smith's nephew, his "special friend".³⁴ The Hill House debate, then, took place some time in 1570, or early 1571.

In 1571 three of the four participants in the debate were actively involved in military and diplomatic affairs. Specifically, Sir Thomas Smith, his son and Sir Humphrey Gilbert were all actively engaged in the Elizabethan conquest and settlement of Ireland. Gilbert (the ruthless suppressor by force of the Fitzmaurice rebellion) and Smith junior (shortly to head the military campaign for the Smith family settlement venture in the Ards) argue the case for Marcellus, whose unscrupulousness and ruthlessness Livy contrasts with Fabius' measured strategy. Sir Thomas Smith and the elderly diplomat Haddon win the debate with their case for the rule of law and policy.³⁵ These distinguished Elizabethans used Livy — and Harvey — to work out anew in debate the Roman relationship between morals and action — law and military engagement.

At the bottom of page 518 Harvey writes in the margin:

I ran over this decade on Hannibal in a week, no less speedily than eagerly and sharply, with Thomas Smith, son of Thomas Smith the royal secretary, who was [Smith junior] shortly afterwards royal deputy in the Irish Ards — a young man as prudent as spirited and vigorous. We were freer and sometimes sharper critics of the Carthaginians and the Romans than was fitting for men of our fortune, virtue or even learning, and at least we learnt not to trust any of the ancients or the moderns sycophantically, and to examine the deeds of others, if not with solid judgement, at least with our whole attention. We put much trust in Aristotle's and Xenophon's politics, in Vegetius' book Of Military Affairs and Frontinus' Stratagems. And we chose not always to agree with either Hannibal, or Marcellus, or Fabius Maximus; nor even with Scipio himself.

Evidently the Hill House debate emerged from or accompanied a full-scale reading of the text. This can be dated: the letters patent

³³ See below, p. 42.

³⁴ Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 14-15. The book is now in the Wilmerding deposit, Princeton; another inscription identifies it as "John Wood's book, a gift from the author himself" (Johannis Woddi liber ex ipso Authoris dono).

³⁵ Haddon (1516-72) wrote Elizabeth's answer to Osorius in 1563, published in Paris "through the agency of Sir Thomas Smith, the English ambassador": s.v. Walter Haddon, *Dictionary of National Biography* (hereafter *D.N.B.*). In 1567 Thomas Hatcher published a collection of Haddon's works, *Lucubrationes passim collectae et editae: studio et labore Thomae Hatcheri Cantabrigiensis*; Hatcher also published *In Commendation of Carr and Wilson's Demonsthenes* (s.v. Hatcher, *D.N.B.*). Hatcher and Harvey were apparently friends, and Harvey's copy of Demonsthenes' *Gnomologiae* had previously belonged to Hatcher; Harvey acquired it in 1570.

authorizing the Smiths to embark on a private venture to colonize the Ards region of Ireland were issued on 16 November 1571; Sir Thomas Smith was appointed principal secretary in July 1572, but "long before that" (any time after spring 1571) Burghley and others were referring to him as "secretary"; he left for France on an ambassadorial assignment on 15 December 1571.³⁶ Thomas Smith junior, Sir Thomas's natural and only son, was recruiting volunteers in Liverpool early in 1572, and was killed in Ireland, during the unsuccessful first attempt to establish the Smith venture, in October 1573.³⁷ So the reading referred to also took place some time early in 1571. This date is corroborated by a remark in Harvey's *Four Letters* (London, 1592), in which he records that the earl of Oxford "bestowed Angels upon mee in Christes Colledge in Cambridge, and otherwise voutsafed me many gracious favours at the affectionate commendation of my Cosen, M. Thomas Smith, the sonne of Sir Thomas, shortly after Colonel of the Ards in Ireland".³⁸ Harvey was elected to a fellowship at Pembroke Hall at the end of 1570, and presumably left Christ's (the college at which he took his B.A.) shortly thereafter — that is, early in 1571.

So while Thomas Smith prepared himself for his crucial military expedition to Ireland (the expedition which was supposed to make his career politically, as well as his own and his father's fortunes), he read Livy with his intellectual companion and close friend ("cosen") Gabriel Harvey. We shall see later what form that reading took (using the copious notes to book three and their repeated references to Thomas Smith's opinions as our guide).

V

"OWR SPECIAL NOTES & PARTICULAR OBSERVATIONS WEE COMMITTED TO WRITING": THE THOMAS PRESTON READING

In 1584 (probably), Harvey read the first decade intensively again, with apparently more academic intent. This time he read with Thomas Preston, newly appointed master of Trinity Hall (a post which Harvey had hoped to win himself).³⁹ That this reading was a "theoretical"

³⁶ Dewar, *Sir Thomas Smith*, pp. 123, 131.

³⁷ D. B. Quinn, "Sir Thomas Smith (1513-1577) and the Beginnings of English Colonial Theory", *Proc. Amer. Philos. Soc.*, lxxxix (1945), pp. 543-60, at pp. 548-9.

³⁸ Cited in Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 65-6.

³⁹ But, as throughout this piece, the marginal notes contradict the conventional account of this failure to achieve office leaving Harvey a broken and disappointed man (based largely on Nashe).

one is made explicit by the fact that its key text was Machiavelli's commentary/discourse on the same decade:

I had reason to take the greater paines in reading the first decad of Liuiē, bie meanes of mie dailie & almost howerlie conference with M. Thomas Preston a fine discourser, & the Queenes onlie pensionar scholler:⁴⁰ when in owre chambers in Trinitie hall with mutch delight, & more profit wee read together in Italian, which the Florentine secretarie writeth with an elegant & sweet grace: Discorsi di Niccolo Machiaueli, sopra la prima deca di Tito Liuiō. Which politike discourses wee thoroughly redd-ouer: with diligent & curious obseruations of the notable actions of the Romans, accomplished at home, & abroad, bie publike, & priuate counsell: at home in the first booke: abroad in the 2; both bie publike counsell: at home & abroad bie priuate counsell, in the 3. Which Method in Machiauels discourses wee soone discovered: & the more easely distinguished his politike positions. Supposing his Councils of state, very fitt to be annexed to owr principall counsels, & souerain decisions in Lawe. Wee then had studied Hotomans Lawe-booke Quaestionum illustrium. And were in hand with Marantas ten disputations Quaestionum legalium.⁴¹

Harvey makes this note at the end of the first decade. At the top of the same page, he writes "Prestons, and Harueys familiar conference concerning the first decad of Liuiē: & of Machiauels politike discourses upon this decad. Owre cheife autours for direction and resolution, were not manie, but essentiall, & for the most part iudicious". To which he had added, at some other time:

Especially Aristotle & Bodine for groundes of pollicie: Sansauino & Danaeus for aphorismes: Patritius & Plutarch for discourse: Hotoman & Maranta for lawe: sumtime Vigelius & excellent Hopperus. Though otherwhiles wee had the Censures of Danaeus & Hotoman in suspition: the one for sum irregular rules, rather Ephorismes, then Aphorismes: the other for his peramptorie & almost seditious Francogallia. Dangerous [the note continues down the right margin] panflets in a monarchie or politike kingdom; & flat opposite to the imperiall ciuil lawe of the prudent, valorous, & reputed iust Romans. Such were owr resolutions vpon Liuiē, & Machiauel. Owre special notes & particular obseruations, both moral, politike, militarie, stratagematical, & other of anie worth or importance, wee committed to writing.

At the close of the text of the first decade, on the page facing the one on which the above remarks are inscribed, Harvey adds a further note on his and Preston's reading of Danaeus:

We have come this far with Daneau's Aphorisms and Machiavelli's Discourses on Livy. But one should note that: "The aphorisms that could be drawn from the third decade were more or less copied from Polybius and

⁴⁰ The *Dictionary of National Biography* tells us that in 1564, in Cambridge, Preston "addressed the queen in a Latin oration on her departure, when she invited him to kiss her hand, and gave him a pension of 20l. a year, with the title of 'her scholar'": s.v. Preston.

⁴¹ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 266.

can be found there too: those that could have been selected from the fourth decade clearly agree with the earlier ones". Therefore Daneau thought he had satisfied his readers fully when he finished his aphorism collection with the first decade. Machiavelli uses much the same method, save in a few details.⁴²

We shall return to these comments on Livy/Danaeus/Machiavelli. For now the point to note is that these remarks specify a close and informed reading, with a diplomatic or political end in mind, evidently with the appropriate books open on the table before them (as was the case when Harvey worked on his dialectic books in this intellectually probing way).⁴³

VI

AUGUSTINE ON LIVY: WHAT IS EXEMPLARY READING?

Around 1590 Harvey left Cambridge permanently in order to practice as a lawyer in the London (ecclesiastical) Court of Arches.⁴⁴ And in 1590 Harvey read Livy from still another point of view — one which for the first time heavily focused on the morality of the Livy. "I haue seene", he wrote,

few, or none fitter obseruations, or pithier discoursers upon diuers notable particulars in Liuie, then sum special chapters in Augustines excellent bookes De Ciuitate Dei. Where he examines, & resolues manie famous actions of the Romans, with as sharp witt, deep iudgment, & pregnant application, as anie of those politicians, discoursers, or other notaries, which I haue read vpon Livie.⁴⁵

As this quotation continues, it is evident that Harvey now has in mind the forensic pleading of cases, and the problem of grafting theology and morality on to the patently pagan heroism of his text — a task for which Augustine's comments on Livy are peculiarly helpful: "Therefore I still saye: [In Latin] Hand me Augustine in those cases which Augustine discusses and settles perceptively and reliably. I know no theologian or dialectician or philosopher or politician, nor even scholar, philologist or critic who is more acute than he". Here, finally, Harvey's engagement with Livy ends, with a rejection of pagan values, and the pagan exemplary figures who go with them, in favour of the Christian ethic:

Certainly here for observations on Livy I prefer Augustine to any other

⁴² *Ibid.*, p. 267.

⁴³ See L. Jardine, "Gabriel Harvey: Exemplary Ramist and Pragmatic Humanist", *Revue des sciences philosophiques et théologiques*, lxx (1986), pp. 36-48.

⁴⁴ Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 80-1.

⁴⁵ Harvey's Livy, sig. Z5', after "finis indicis".

theologian of the highest quality. This is one reader's opinion, that there is hardly a competent judge of Roman history who did not previously have knowledge of Augustine's wise doctrine on the City of God. I am delighted that I have added this at last to the political philosophy of Aristotle and Plato. And I confess that the ideal state of philosophers or heroes is as a shadow by comparison with the City of God.

Gabriel Harvey. 1590.

Harvey did not read *The City of God* on its own, but together with its almost equally vast Renaissance companion, the commentary by Juan Luis Vives, famous for its learning, penetrating inquiries into Augustine's lost sources, and exuberant excursions. In the course of this reading Harvey often found that subjects touched on by Augustine had been studied "a little more precisely" by the modern scholar.⁴⁶ At the end of twenty or more years of political reading, here at last we find a kind of reading which the modern student of humanism would recognize: the personal, moralized, ruminative reading to be adduced tellingly to defend a course of action, or to enhance a specifically Anglican point of view.

VII

THE SETTING FOR READING

Harvey's marginal annotations enable us to build up a picture of consecutive, detailed readings of Livy, given point and direction by a specified occasion for reading and (sometimes) companion with whom to read. At this point, as part of our historical reconstruction, we need a digression on equipment. For it should be apparent from the examples of "readings" of Livy cited, that Harvey did not give his attention to one book at a time, even when reading in company. Even from among the comparatively small number of his annotated books which survive (or have been traced) his marginal notes make it clear that he annotated groups of books together on any one occasion, always in the same regular hand, with an even pen-pressure which does not suggest any awkwardness in writing or reading (he rarely blots or erases a single word). In the case of the Livy, there is at least the sense that the Livy text is, so to speak, *central* — that it sits at the centre of the reading. In other cases, such as the annotations of groups of dialectic books, and associated classical works (Cicero's *Topica*, Quintilian's *Institutiones oratoriae*, Demosthenes' *Gnomolog-*

⁴⁶ *Ibid.*, p. 310; see below, pp. 53-4, for a fuller treatment.

iae), it is by no means clear which text sits at the centre of the reader's field of vision and attention.⁴⁷

How did Harvey read a large number of volumes systematically? The sheer practical problems of keeping from five to fifteen parallel texts and reference works constantly at hand seem daunting. So does that of entering notes in all of them, as Harvey did, in a handwriting more elaborate than that of "many a copyholder or magistral scribe that holds all his living by setting schoolboys copies" (as Nashe, his enemy, described it).⁴⁸ How did he muster the vast amount of uncluttered flat surface that this exercise in close reading and fine penmanship required?

Roger Chartier has recently called attention to the many changes that our devices for storing books have undergone. He illustrates one of the most strikingly alien of these to be produced in early modern Europe: the book-wheel. (See Plate.) This splendid combination of cabinetry and cog-wheels was new in the sixteenth century. As Ramelli's illustration shows, it enabled its user to lay out on flat surfaces as many books as he might choose, to move them as he needed them without losing his places, and to stop at any selected text — thanks to the cog-wheels.⁴⁹ Jacopo Corbinelli saw such a wheel in the library of the great jurist Cujas at Valence. It could hold

60 or 70 portions out of large volumes, open, not counting the tiny ones. You sit and with your hand you bring portions of these large volumes before you three at a time. To put it in a nutshell, you can make a whole study revolve, and so easily that it is a delightful exercise.⁵⁰

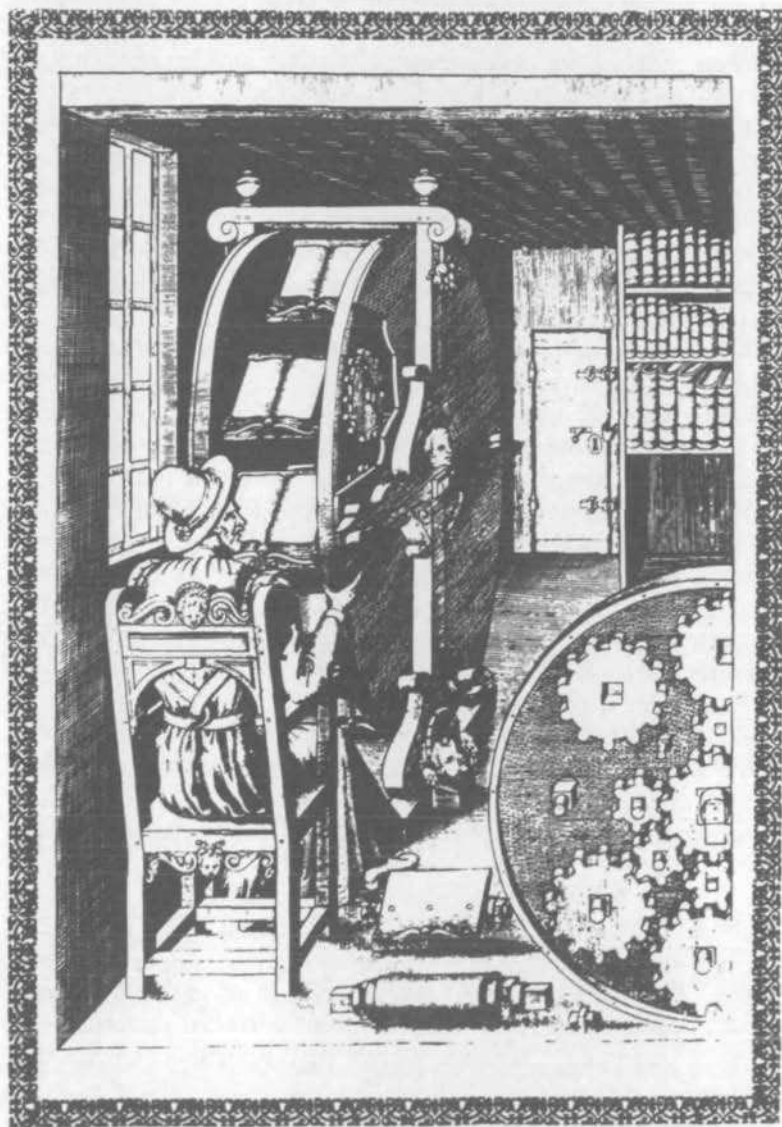
Harvey's method of reading requires something like the book-wheel to be physically feasible. And the book-wheel, when seen in the new light cast on it by Harvey's practices, is more than a

⁴⁷ It was Robert Darnton who first asked us why we believed that in a reading of a group of texts any single text *necessarily* had to be at the centre of the reading. We express our gratitude to him for launching us on a train of thought which led us eventually, after a certain amount of detective work, to the book-wheel.

⁴⁸ T. Nashe, *Selected Writings*, ed. S. Wells (Cambridge, Mass., 1965), p. 285.

⁴⁹ Bill Saslaw has brought to our attention a modern version of the rotating desk, in which the outer and central sections of a circular desk rotated independently, horizontally: it was owned by Harlow Shapley, director of the Harvard College Observatory in the 1930s, and remained in the office he had occupied until the 1960s. For a photograph, see H. Shapley, *Ad astra per aspera: Through Rugged Ways to the Stars* (New York, 1969).

⁵⁰ R. Calderini de Marchi, *Jacopo Corbinelli et les érudits français d'après la correspondance inédite Corbinelli-Pinelli (1566-1587)* (Milan, 1914), p. 176. Ramelli's plate had already been reproduced, together with a photograph of a surviving book-wheel in Wolfenbüttel and useful remarks, in A. Hobson, *Great Libraries* (London, 1970), pp. 206-7. Another working example is to be found in the Bibliotheca Thysiana, Leiden.



The book-wheel from *The Various and Ingenious Machines of Agostino Ramelli*, ed. M. Teach Gnudi and E. S. Ferguson (New York and Aldershot, 1987), p. 509.

Photo: by permission of Dover Publications

device for neat storage of momentarily interesting texts. It belongs to Harvey's cultural moment, in which collation and parallel citation were an essential, constructive part of a particular kind of reading; it allowed the imbedding of text in context, after the fashion that Harvey and (we would argue) many of his professional academic contemporaries practised. The book-wheel and the centrifugal mode of reading it made possible amounted to an effective form of information retrieval — and that in a society where books were seen as offering powerful knowledge, and the reader who could focus the largest number of books on a problem or an opportunity would therefore appear to have the advantage.⁵¹

We suggest that it was people who did accumulate volumes who conceived of themselves as "readers" in the sense in which we are excavating the term and provided themselves with the modern machinery for making such reading possible. In other words, the book-wheel suggests a social perception of certain individuals as skilled readers, as other men might be skilled woodworkers or leatherworkers.⁵² We imagine Harvey using the book-wheel — or a rival device — in London, during the periods in which we know he was employed for his reading skills, in some kind of advisory, secretarial position (notably 1577-8, 1580 and 1590; dated readings in surviving volumes cluster closely round these dates).

The reader at the book-wheel is an unfamiliar *type*: the reader as facilitator. The reader, himself immobile and attentive to his books, is the agent to another's action, employed in the activity of reading in such a way that his own selfhood as a reader is not at issue. Ramelli, describing his "artful machine", suggests that it might well serve a man with gout — who found movement difficult and painful — and this captures the intermediary quality of the book-wheel reading. It is not the scholar-reader who acts, but it is he who facilitates action.⁵³

We propose the book-wheel as a kind of emblem — it (or something like it, allowing consultation and annotation of multiple volumes simultaneously) represents the professional reader or facilitator's "tools of his trade". And we suggest that in spite of the fact that

⁵¹ We suggest that this adds point to Chartier's evidence that remarkably few readers owned quantities of books (rather than one or two culturally key texts like the Bible and the Golden Legend): Chartier, *Cultural Uses of Print*.

⁵² Categories of persons who Chartier shows to have been familiar with print, but who were not "expert" readers.

⁵³ See, for instance, Roger Ascham's 1541 letter to Archbishop Edward Lee, offering him his services as just such a reader, in *The Whole Works of Roger Ascham*, ed. J. A. Giles, 3 vols. (London, 1865), i, pp. 17-19, at p. 19.

history has apparently left little trace of this activity outside the as yet under-explored marginal notes in contemporary volumes, Harvey's was not an unusual activity for a sixteenth-century intellectual, but was consistent with the kind of professional service that Henry Cuffe performed for the earl of Essex, and John Dee for Edward Dyer.⁵⁴ As Harvey wrote to Leicester in 1579: "I speake it without vanity that a poore litle schollar would do your Lordshippe more honour in his speciall respects then sum of your gallants and courtlyest servants".⁵⁵

VIII

SOME BOOKS ON THE WHEEL IN 1580

In August 1580 Edmund Spenser, secretary in Leicester's service, left for Ireland with Lord Grey, and Gabriel Harvey entered Leicester's employment in his place.⁵⁶ A striking group of historical and political texts belonging to Harvey are inscribed with the date "1580", either on their title-page, or somewhere in the marginalia. We may take these as a sample of what was "on the wheel" during Harvey's first known period of public service. The works are as follows:

T. Livii Patavini, Romanae historiae principis, decades tres, cum dimidia . . . (Basle, 1555);⁵⁷

The Arte of Warre: Written in Italian by Nicholas Machiuel: And Set Foorth in English by Peter Withorne . . . (London, 1573);⁵⁸

Florio his First Fruites: A Perfect Induction to the Italian and English Tongues (London, 1578);⁵⁹

⁵⁴ See above, pp. 31, 33-4. As Nicholas Clulee suggests, Dee's involvement in the various projects of the Sidney/Dyer group was not that of an initiator, but a seeker of documentary precedents for policy — in our terms a facilitator. See N. H. Clulee, *John Dee's Natural Philosophy: Between Science and Religion* (London, 1988), p. 188: "In summary, Dee's major role in these projects for exploration was in the definition of the ideological context of ideas of a British Empire in which they took place and not that of a technical advisor let alone that of a leader in the movement". Linda Levy Peck gives an account of Sir Robert Cotton's work as an advisor to the earl of Northampton between 1603 and 1614 which closely matches our model of reading for policy-making: L. Levy Peck, *Northampton: Patronage and Policy at the Court of James I* (London, 1982), pp. 103-4.

⁵⁵ Historical Manuscripts Commission, *Marquess of Bath MSS.*, 5 vols. (London, 1904-80), v, *Talbot, Dudley and Devereux Papers, 1533-1659*, p. 199. We owe this reference to Paul Hammer.

⁵⁶ Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 68.

⁵⁷ "G.H. 1580" at end of first long note.

⁵⁸ "1580. C" on the title-page. Now in Princeton Univ. Lib., Lucius Wilmerding Jr. deposit. For location of the other volumes in this list, see Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*.

⁵⁹ Dated 1580 at end of text, just above "finis". At end of text, above "finis", at top of fo. Eei^r, Harvey writes: "Florio, & Eliot mie new London Companions for Italian, & French[e?]. Two of the best for both". And lower down the page (later): "Now to the
(cont. on p. 50)

William Thomas, *The Historie of Italie* (London, 1561);⁶⁰

The Strategemes, Sleyghtes, and Policies of Warre, Gathered Togethyer, by S. Julius Frontinus, and Translated into Englyshe, by Richard Morysine (London, 1539);⁶¹

Paulus Jovius, *Libellus de legatione Basilii magni principis Moschoviae ad Clementem VII: pontificem max. in quo situs regionis antiquis incognitus, religio gentis, mores, & causae legationis fidelissime referuntur* . . . (Basle, 1527);⁶²

T. Livii Patavini conciones, cum argumentis et annotationibus Ioachimi Perionij . . . (Paris, 1532);⁶³

Politique Discourses, Treating of the Differences and Inequalities of Vocations, as well Publique, as Priuate: With the Scopes or Endes Whereunto They are Directed: Translated out of French by Aegremont Rauclyffe Esquire (London, 1578);⁶⁴

Ioannes de Sacrobosco, *Textus de sphaera* . . . *introductoria additione* . . . *commentarioque, ad utilitatem studentium philosophiae Parisiensis Academiae illustratus* . . . (Paris, 1527);⁶⁵

P. Du Ploiche, *A Treatise in Englishe and Frenche, Right Necessarie and Profitable for all Young Children* . . . (London, 1578);⁶⁶

Deti et fatti piacevoli, et gravi: di diversi principi, filosofi, et cortigiani: raccolti dal Guicciardini: et ridotti a moralita (Venice, 1571);⁶⁷

Lucae Gaurici geophonensis, episcopi civitatensis, tractatus astrologicus (Venice, 1552);⁶⁸

(n. 59 cont.)

4. books of Guazzo [1581], the sweetest & daintiest of Italian Dialogues. Then to Eliots French Dialogues: as fine, as those Italian, & more pleasant . . .". Harvey's copy of John Eliot, *Ortho-epia Gallica: Eliots First Fruits for the French* (London, 1593), survives: Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 211.

⁶⁰ Title-page missing, no date. But marginal annotations contemporary with other 1580 volumes, for example (cited in Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 237): "Excellent Histories, & notable Discourses for everie politician, pragmatician, negotiatour, or anie skillfull man. A necessarie Introduction to Machiavel, Guicciardin, Jovius". And complete passages of Thomas are transcribed in the margins of Harvey's Florio.

⁶¹ (Hereafter Harvey's Frontinus). Dated 1580 on first blank page.

⁶² Title-page missing, but annotations contemporary with 1580 volumes.

⁶³ Dated 1578 on title-page and last page, but contains marginal notes contemporary with Harvey's Livy. In assembling this list we noted that a good number of these works (and some others) were acquired and/or read thoroughly for the first time in 1578. Another large set of books can be identified for 1590.

⁶⁴ "Gabriel Harvey, et amicorum". Not dated, but notes contemporary with 1580 volumes.

⁶⁵ Not yet seen. "gabrielis harvejus", "Plus in recessu, quam in fronte", "Arte et virtute. 1580" on title-page: Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 233-4.

⁶⁶ Not seen. *Ibid.*, p. 210.

⁶⁷ Not seen. *Ibid.*, p. 218: "gabriel harvejo. Ratione, et diligentia. 1580".

⁶⁸ Not seen. "gabriel harvejus. 1580" on title-page; "gabrielis harveij, et amicorum. 1580" at end. Discussion of Harvey's use of astrology must wait for another time and place. We have omitted a couple more "1580" volumes whose topics are not relevant to the discussion as currently framed: Pindar (see *ibid.*, p. 230), Rowlands, *The Post of the World* (see *ibid.*, p. 233), and Tusser, *Five Hundred Pointes of Good Husbandrie* (see *ibid.*, pp. 237-8).

Ioachim Hopperus, *In veram iurisprudentiam Isagoges ad filium libri octo* . . . (Cologne, 1580);⁶⁹

Iuris civilis totius absolutissima methodus: in qua, bone lector, non solum omnes totius iuris civilis titulos, sed & singulas singulorum titulorum leges, singulos singularum legum paragraphos, miro ordine ad suos locos habes redactos & dispositos: opus multis retro annis, a multis doctissimis uiris exoptatum, a multis tentatum, tandem auctoris sumptibus perfectum: autore Nicolao Vigelio iurisconsulto (Basle, J. Oporinus, 1561).⁷⁰

These volumes and their annotations give a vivid, concrete sense of what it meant to engage in the activity of reading as Harvey did, in 1580 (in preparing this paper we have had the annotations for the first eight volumes on this list before us, and six volumes before us simultaneously, either physically — the first two on the list — or in photographic reproduction — the next four). In addition to the richness and density of annotation throughout them, there is persistent echoing of sentiments from one book to another; cross-referencing of one of these authors in the margins of another; recognizable continuity of handwriting, to the extent that we can sometimes hazard a guess as to which book succeeded which other in the circulating process of reading and annotation; narrative notes about contemporary or near contemporary affairs continued from the margins of one volume to another (notably, from the back of the Frontinus to the margins of the Florio; and from the Thomas to the margins of Florio). Cumulatively, the effect is one of unexpected *cohesiveness* — a sense of the grouped volumes as cohering around a project which Harvey (the reader) keeps constantly before him.⁷¹

IX

POSITIONING THE READING: CHOOSING YOUR OCCASION

The Sidney, Smith junior, Preston and “Arches” readings by Harvey of his Livy (to which we can assign fairly precise dates) give us distinctive contexts for reading (and therefore, we shall argue, distinctive “ways of reading”, which need have little in common with one another). The first (chronologically, with Smith junior) we, like Harvey, might term “pragmatic” — or “militarie, stratagematical”. This reading is addressed by the prior agreement of the readers to a

⁶⁹ “Gabrielis Harveij, 1580” on title-page: Moore Smith, *Gabriel Harvey's Marginalia*, pp. 175-87; Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, p. 221.

⁷⁰ Gonville and Caius College, Cambridge, H.6.12. Title-page: “GabrielisHarueij. 1580. Mense Aprile.”, “Arte, et Virtute”. (Not in Stern).

⁷¹ Unexpected, because a twentieth-century reader would not anticipate volumes with this range of topics and subject-matter converging on anything.

specific Elizabethan political context, and in particular, to the demands of impending military campaigns. The version of strategy which it yielded turned out in the event to be of limited relevance to the task in hand, and we might want to argue that this is intrinsic to the sources: Livy was never very strong on campaigns.⁷² This was also, one might add, Harvey's earliest engagement with "politics" via history, and therefore arguably the most ambitious in terms of the pay-off he hoped for.

The second reading (with Sidney) we might term "moral, politique". This, we would argue, is a careerist reading — one designed to promote the career of a courtier, and at the same time to bring the hopeful facilitator to the notice of a court circle. This side of Harvey (and of his reading) has been repeatedly invoked by those who have encountered his marginalia, but needs to be looked at again, as we shall do here. The appropriate context is provided by the closing passages of a familiar letter from Harvey to John Wood.⁷³

The salient point is that Harvey treats the relationship between university political theory and court political practice as reciprocal: "you must needs acknowledge us your Masters in all generall poyntes of Gouernment, and ye greate Archepollycyes of all aoulde, and newe Commo[n] welthes". "Particular matters of counsell, and pollicye, besides daylye freshe newes, and A thousande both ordinary, and extraordinary occurrents, and accidents in ye worlde" are provided by those actively engaged in law and politics: but these nevertheless must be assessed against the general theory that only university men can provide.⁷⁴

The third reading with Preston is the one which historians of political thought might want to take most seriously. It solidly exemplifies the aspiration generally stated in the letter to Wood: that university men should be able to provide political theory to match

⁷² See Jardine, "Mastering the Uncouth".

⁷³ We have used Walter Colman's transcription, which we gratefully acknowledge.

⁷⁴ One might want to observe that the somewhat insistent note in Harvey's remarks about the usefulness of university men to the court has less to do with pushiness than with the need to earn a living. There are a number of points in Harvey's biography, starting with the Pembroke quarrel with Neville, where it is obvious that Harvey's career is suffering from his not being a man of means, and therefore financially self-sufficient *before* any earnings from the various posts he sought. See, for example, the letter to the master of Pembroke, John Young, on the disputed Greek lectureship in 1574: "For the bestowing of the lecture, do in it as you shal think best for the behoof of the Collidg. For mi part I am the more desirus of it, I must needs confes, bicaus of the stipend, which notwithstanding is not great": Brit. Lib., Sloane MS. 93, fos. 27^v-34^r, cited in Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 26-7. Contrast Sir Thomas Smith's earnings, as itemized in the *Dictionary of National Biography*.

contemporary political requirements.⁷⁵ It is a reading which the marginal notes "position" rather carefully. As we have seen, Harvey and Preston took care to note that while Hotman's *Francogallia* was relevant to their discussion, its Tacitean argument that the king's right to rule depended upon the favour of the people rather than on right of inheritance was seditious.⁷⁶

Harvey's reading of Livy with Augustine, though perhaps solitary in execution, had at least two distinct purposes. On the one hand, Augustine was himself a rich source for the early history of Rome. As Vives pointed out, he had read the lost books of Livy and the lost works of the great Roman scholar Varro; accordingly, even in his opposition to Roman values, he filled in many details tantalizingly omitted or left vague in Livy. Read with Vives's commentary — which tried to use all available information to dot every i of fact, date or place-name that Augustine had left incomplete — *The City of God* made a splendid reference book. And it was thus that Harvey used it when, for example, he referred to Augustine's "extremely important chapter" (*caput valdè notabile* — v.22) on the duration of Rome's wars with the Carthaginians, Mithridates and the pirates, and remarked "see also Vives's commentary" (*observandis etiam L. Vives animadversionibus*). Augustine's chapter lists the durations of these wars to show that they depend on God's decision; Vives's commentary emphasizes historical details, locations of battles and alternate values for the durations found in other classical sources.⁷⁷

On the other hand, Harvey also makes many references, direct and implicit, to Augustine's historical doctrines. Unlike Augustine's contemporary, Orosius, and many of his own contemporaries, he grasped Augustine's view of Roman virtue and the moral use of

⁷⁵ The letter to Fulke Greville which we cited earlier takes an almost identical position (even down to the "tags" used): "The . . . hardest point is y^e Choice of the Notes themselves: w^{ch} must be naturall, morall, Politick, or Military. Of the 2 first your Gatherers may haue good Iudgment; but you shall haue little use: of the 2 later, yo^r use is greatest, and their Iudgement least. I doubt not, but in the Universitie you shall find Choice of many excellent Witts, and in things, wherein they haue waded, manie of good Understanding. But they that haue the best Eyes, are not alwaies the best Lapidaries and according to the Proverb, The greatest Clarks are not euer the wisest men. A meer Scholar in State, or Military Matters will no more satisfie you, then Phormio did Han[n]ibal": Bodleian Lib., Tanner MS. 79, fos. 29^r-30^r, at fos. 30^r-v.

⁷⁶ On Hotman's "red Tacitism", see P. Burke, "Tacitism", in T. A. Dorey (ed.), *Tacitus* (London, 1969).

⁷⁷ Harvey's Livy, p. 268; Augustine, *De civitate Dei libri XXII*, ed. L. Vives (Lyons, 1580), pp. 325-6; on Augustine's use of lost sources, see *ibid.*, pp. 208-9, where Vives comments on iv.1.

examples from Roman history. He picked out key chapters — like i.15, the long treatment of the Roman hero Regulus — for recording in his margins. And he made clear that he understood Augustine's fundamental insistence, in this and similar passages, that even in shared virtues — like those that animated Regulus to sacrifice his life for Rome — the Christians outdid the pagans.⁷⁸ This reading was genuinely Augustinian in tone and content — and we are currently undecided as to how Harvey reconciled it with his other readings.⁷⁹

At the end of the Livy are two Harvey notes which we may take as our own "positioning". Both relate the reading of history to Harvey's own mentors and patrons, and thus to the immediate social and political context of his study of Livy. The first (after the "Finis") relates to Sir Thomas Smith, Harvey's hero on at least three grounds: for his personal support of Harvey's own university studies and encouragement of his political career aspirations; for his own exemplary progress via political theory and university office to the diplomatic service and high government office; and for his uncompromising intellectual and publishing career:

Sir Thomas Smyth, the Queenes principal secretarie; in his trauails in Fraunce, Italie, Spaine, & Germanie; but especially in his ambassages in Scotland, Fraunce, & Netherlande; found no sutch use of anie autours, as I heard himself say, as of Liuius, Plutarch, & Iustinian. He much commended Sallust, Suetonius, Tacitus, & sum other of the best: but his classical and statarie historians were Liuius, Plutarch, Halicarnasseus; & verie fewe other. Of the new, Cominaeus, Guicciardine, Jouius, Paulus AEmilius, Egnatius, & but fewe other. Not the most, but the Best; was his rule. And I am for Geometrical, not Arithmetical Proportion. An other of owre cunningest, & shrewdest ambassadours in Fraunce, Sir Nicholas Throgmorton, was altogether for Cesar, & Liuius; Liuius & Cesar. Not a more resolute man in Ingland: & few deeper heds: as Mie Lord Burgley will still saye.⁸⁰

The second note, at the end of the *elenchus* of Glareanus, sets up the relationship between the various reading contexts just described, and the Livy:

⁷⁸ Harvey's Livy, p. 268.

⁷⁹ Harvey manages to reconcile Livy and Augustine at least once, in an interesting note on the beginning of book thirty-one (*ibid.*, p. 519), where he has Livy and Augustine agree unproblematically about the forces that propelled Rome to world empire. But we still cannot reconcile these remarks with the others quoted in our exposition. Our thanks to Jill Kraye for comment on this and other points.

⁸⁰ *Ibid.*, p. 829. This seems to be the only reference to Throckmorton in the marginalia. Throckmorton and Smith were ambassadors together in France in 1562-4: according to the *Dictionary of National Biography* (s.v. Sir Thomas Smith), Smith junior — aged fifteen — was in France with his father on this embassy. Throckmorton died in February 1571.

The notablest men, that first commended the often & aduised reading of Liue vnto mee, were theise fue, Doctor Henrie Haruey, M. Roger Ascham, Sir Thomas Smyth, Sir Walter Mildmay, Sir Philip Sidney: all learned, expert, & verie iudicious in the greatest matters of priuate, or publique qualitie. Once I heard M. Secretarie Wilson, & Doctor Binge preffer the Romane historie before the Greeke, or other: and Liue before anie other Romane historie. But of all other Sir Philip Sidney, Colonel Smyth [i.e. Smith junior], and Monsieur Bodin wunne mie hart to Liue. Sir Philip Sidney esteemes no general Historie, like Iustines abridgment of Trogus: nor anie special Roman historie like Liue: nor anie particular historie, Roman, or other, like the singular life, & actions of Cesar: Whome he values aboue all other, & reputes the greatest actour, that euer the World did afforde. And therefore makes exceeding account of Sallust, Velleius, Suetonius in Latin; Plutarch, Dion, Iulian in Greeke: Who as effectually, as briefly display him in his liuelie colours. But of none makes so high reckoning as of Cesars owne Commentaries, peerles & inualuable works. Where his frends, & enimies beholde a most worthie man; modest in profession; pithie in discourse; discreet in iudgment; sound in resolution; quiet in expedition; constant in industrie; most vigorous in most daunger; surmounting the wisest in pollicie, the brauest in valour, the terriblest in execution, the cunningest in huge artificial works; allwaies inuincible, often incomparable, sumtime admirable in the accomplishment of the weightiest affaires, dowtiest exploits, & finest designes, that could be plotted bie himself in the profunditie of his surprising conceit. The onlie Mirrour of most excellent valour, & more excellent Witt: to this day vnmatchable, in so manie reuolutions of high, & deepe spirits; aspiring to the greatest things vpon Earth; & leauing no possibilitie vnextended. Yet amongst so manie valorous minds, & euen amongst so many puissant Cesars, still but one Cesar. He, that brauely gaue it owt for his resolute word, Aut Caesar, aut nihil: howsoeuer exceedingly beholden to Machiavel, was indeed nihil in comparison of Cesar.⁸¹

On the one hand we have Henry Harvey, Roger Ascham, Sir Thomas Smith and Sir Walter Mildmay, "all learned, expert, & verie iudicious in the greatest matters of priuate, or publique qualitie" — significant men with one foot in the university world, the other in diplomacy. On the other we have Smith junior and Bodin (of whom more shortly), distinctively in the world of politics, strategy and opportunity. In the middle we have Sir Philip Sidney, symbol, even before his death, of both camps — the man of cultivation and learning, court figure and literary darling, but whose achievements were cemented by his exemplary performances in active military engagement (and in the first place, in Ireland).⁸²

⁸¹ Harvey's *Livy*, sig. P 1^r. This note can be dated before 1586, since Sidney's views are recorded in the present tense.

⁸² See the verses written by Harvey for the Cambridge volume *Academiae Cantabrigiensis lachrymae tumulo nobilissimi equitis: d. Philippi Sidneyj* (1587). The second poem is headed, "De subito & praemature interitu nobilis viri, Philippi Sydneij, utriusque militiae, tam armatae, quam togatae, clarissimi equitis" (Concerning the sudden and premature death of that noble man, Philip Sidney, the most celebrated knight of both kinds of office, as much of arms as of civil affairs).

X

IF THIS IS READING, WHAT WAS POLITICAL THOUGHT?

There seems no reason not to take seriously Harvey's aspiration to read Roman history in a way directly applicable to contemporary affairs of state. We take Bodin, Machiavelli, Daneau and Hotman seriously because they published (thus demonstrating a persisting academic preference for the treatise as "authentic" intellectual history). It might, however, be argued that Harvey is a better source for understanding of Elizabethan political thought, precisely because his observations are juxtaposed with the text of Livy itself, and because, as he indicates, contemporary politicians valued the readings he gave. As to whether Harvey's claims to have the ear of the politically influential are genuine: the claims of individuals are often, in intellectual history, our only guide to contact and influence. And although the pamphleteering Nashe has seen to it that posterity disparages Gabriel Harvey's achievements, it is interesting to note how often Nashe's jibes may equally be read as *confirming* Harvey's own claims.⁸³

Harvey's methods and concerns were clearly shared with those members of the political élite with whom he claimed connections. Thomas Smith, his patron — and an eminently respectable figure in modern histories of political thought — lived in a world as steeped in classical texts and modern technical writers as Harvey's own. Smith's friend Walter Haddon once wrote to ask his opinion of a recent dinner-table conversation where the French ambassador had denied that Cicero was a competent lawyer (an argument that "became so heated that it was very hard to find a way to end it"). Smith replied

⁸³ See, for example, Nashe's remarks about Harvey's legal practice in the Court of Arches, cited by Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 81-2. Or we may choose to accept Harvey's own word (as set out in a 1598 letter to Sir Robert Cecil) that given the opportunity, in the form of reliable financial support and secure employment, he would have published: "manie other mie Traicts & Discourses, sum in Latin, sum in English, sum in verse according to the circumstance of the occasion, but much more in prose; sum in Humanitie, Historie, Pollicy, Lawe, & the sowle of the whole Boddie of Law, Reason; sum in Mathematiques, in Cosmographie, in the Art of Navigation, in the Art of Warr, in the tru Chymique without imposture (which I learned of your most learned predecessour, Sir Thomas Smith, not to contemne) & other effectual practible knowlage, in part hetherto unrevealed, in part unskilfully handeled for the matter, or obscurely for the forme; with more speculative conceit, then industrious practis, or Method, the two discovering eies of this age". For, says Harvey: "I had ever an earnest & curious care of sound knowledg, & esteemed no reading, or writing without matter of effectual use in esse: as I hope shoold soone appeare, if I were settled in a place of competent maintenance, or had but a foundation to build upon": *ibid.*, p. 125.

at length from Paris, where he was serving as English ambassador, with appropriate diplomatic tact, that Cicero had been a splendid lawyer, *given the condition of the law of his day*. The scholar-diplomat's mature grasp on such issues, which enabled him to reply so deftly to a difficult question, came from the circle of "facilitators" he frequented in Paris. He had been discussing such issues — though less frequently than he would have liked — with Petrus Ramus and Louis le Roy, as he had discussed them years before with their predecessor at the Collège Royal, Jean Strazel.⁸⁴ And he would soon produce a spectacularly successful adaptation of his own of an ancient model for political writing: a brilliant account of England's institutions, modelled on his "conjectural reconstruction of the form used by Aristotle in his lost books on many of the Greek states".⁸⁵ Very likely it was Smith who introduced Harvey to the thought of Bodin — whose innovative ideas on inflation Smith accepted.⁸⁶

In at least one case we can watch Harvey and the Smiths, father and son, responding to a single supplementary reading of a sharply "political" kind. Harvey remarks on his reading of the third decade that:

M. Thomas Smith, & I reading this decade of Liuię together, found verie good vse of M. Antonie Copes English historie of the two most noble Capitaines of the World, Annibal, & Scipio. Which sumtime giues a notable light to Liuię; & was worthie to be dedicated to King Henrie the VIII. in the opinion of Sir Thomas Smith, who much commended it to his sonne. [In Latin] However, it is sweeter to drink the waters from the very source. And I am one of those who will never have had their fill of Livy's wise and lively style.⁸⁷

The introduction to Cope's *Historye of the Two Most Noble Captaynes of the World, Anniball and Scipio* (London, 1548), specifies in an introductory letter (to which Harvey here refers) that Cope writes as a scholar (he was chamberlain to Queen Katherine Parr), to make his own scholarly contribution to knowledge useful for warfare and conquest. Among the military achievements which Cope maintains contribute to Henry VIII's international political standing he includes "the wyse and woorthy conquest of the realme of Irelande, wher of at this present your maiestee weareth the Diademe".⁸⁸ An appropriate

⁸⁴ W. Haddon, *Lucubrations* (London, 1567), pp. 280-1, 284-7. See also above, p. 42.

⁸⁵ Haddon, *Lucubrations*, p. 306.

⁸⁶ See Thomas Smith, *A Discourse of the Commonweal of this Realm of England*, ed. M. Dewar (Charlottesville, 1969), pp. xv n. 14, xxvi.

⁸⁷ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 269.

⁸⁸ A. Cope, *Historye of the Two Most Noble Captaynes of the World, Anniball and Scipio* (London, 1548), sig. aiv^r.

volume for Sir Thomas Smith to draw to the attention of his son as part of his "political" preparation for the Ards campaign. Harvey's racily pragmatic annotations in English to this decade do indeed appear to take their tone from the Cope. For example, at the top of the page following the inscription above: "Annibal, a laborious & hardie; a valiant & a terrible Youth. A ventrous & redowted Captain in the Prime of his age. [In Latin] He acted accordingly".⁸⁹ And at the top of the next: "The Romanes neuer so matched & tamed, as bie Annibal a long time. And therefore his Historie the more notable in manie weightie respects".⁹⁰ In his copy of Frontinus — which we have on our book-wheel; and which elsewhere in the Livy Harvey notes he and Smith included in their reading — Harvey heads the discussion of Hannibal's tactics "in Aphrike agaynste Scipio": "Y^e order of Annibal, & Scipio, in that most famous battel betwene them. These orders, more particularly analyzed in y^e English History of Annibal, & Scipio: owt of Liuy, &c".⁹¹

Observations such as these (which in Harvey's Livy form a series of running heads to the third decade) represent Hannibal as a freebooting buccaneer. They culminate in a marginal note to the speech of Hannibal's which closes the decade. In this speech Hannibal, who has been recalled to Carthage after sixteen years' sustained combat against the Romans, philosophically comes to terms with his situation, sues for peace as instructed, and warns Scipio not to trust in fortune, but only in reason. At the top of the page Harvey records Thomas Smith's enthusiasm for such lofty thoughts from the great captain of the world:

M. Smith, Colonel of the Ardes in Ireland, did maruell at nothing more in all Liuiē, then at this discreete, & respectiue oration of Annibal, after so manie braue resolutions, impetuous aduentures, & maine battels. [In Latin] A wise oration of Hannibal's.

Full of sagacity, tried and tested, and maturely reflected upon.⁹²

These last two sentences are from an earlier reading, possibly actually contemporary with the Smith reading, as opposed to retrospective (the first note). At the bottom of the page Harvey writes:

Here at last we see Hannibal as more a cautious counsellor than a fierce general. It is not surprising that Hannibal made Fabius a politician and a

⁸⁹ Harvey's Livy, p. 270.

⁹⁰ *Ibid.*, p. 271.

⁹¹ Harvey's Frontinus, sig. E iv^v-E v^r. See above, p. 50.

⁹² Harvey's Livy, p. 511.

pragmatic:⁹³ for Scipio makes Hannibal himself orator and philosopher. The spirit of youthful courage is one thing; that of mature prudence, another; that of old age's temperance, yet another. Each has its own diction, its own style, more or less temperate and, as it were, bridled.⁹⁴

XI

AFFECTIVE STYLE: AN EFFECTIVE FORCE FOR ACTION

There seems to be an interesting tension here, between the *aspiration* to find advice on tactics and stratagems in such episodes, and Harvey's very evident attraction to the stylistic and affective in such a speech. Once again, this contributes to our sense of the reader, Harvey, as intermediary between text and its effect in practice: style and affectiveness are textual catalysts; the occasions for their recall may be those on which oratory does indeed provoke, and alters the course of events. There is clearly a strong sense in which Harvey sees the cut and thrust of political debate — particularly in the pointed exchange between military adversaries — as a serious and important part of "gaining the upper hand" in political and military affairs. Near the beginning of the Livy he has a long note on Livy's style and its importance:

Livy's style, especially in the speeches. No Latin or Greek speeches deserve more careful reading or meticulous selection than Livy's; Péron assembled them into a sort of technical order. Hence, when I have time to read, or to imitate, or even to emulate speeches, I prefer no others to these, or others of Livy's, which are both sharp in sense and polished in expression. Nothing, in general, is either more toughly concise, or more vividly expressed. Atticism itself seems to be outdone here. [Later] The style is meticulously polished here: now splendidly ample, now brilliantly concise, now expertly modulated, often adamant. It is always budding or flowering. Had he not known Caesar, Sallust, Virgil intimately, I would find his method of composition amazing. It is at once so brilliant and so solid; no more brilliant than grave, no less subtle than ornate. [Later] Certain well-rounded and clever sayings — like Spartan apophthegms — are also most delightful. His variety almost never fails, and his strength almost never flags. This judgement is still mine; nor could I be easily induced or desperately coerced to adopt another view.⁹⁵

⁹³ We translate Harvey's "*pragmaticus*" as "pragmatic" throughout, for want of a more appropriate word. Harvey takes the term directly from Cicero, *De oratore*, where Antonius advises the orator not to fill his head with legal detail, but to employ someone to get it up for him: "This is why, in the lawcourts, those who are the most accomplished practitioners retain advisors who are expert in the law (even though they are very expert themselves), and who are called 'pragmatics'" (Itaque illi disertissimi homines ministros habent in causis iuris peritos, cum ipsi sint peritissimi, et qui . . . pragmatici vocantur). See also Quintilian, *Institutiones oratoriae*, xii.3.4.

⁹⁴ Harvey's Livy, p. 511.

⁹⁵ *Ibid.*, leaf facing p. 1, recto.

When we turn to Harvey's copy of Livy's *Conciones* we do indeed find them annotated confidently as politically effective (not simply exercises in speech-making):

Anyone must be delighted by that vividly varied style. Relevant here are the political letters of Mehmet II to popes, emperors, kings, princes, states, with the answers. Also some very prudent and sharp opinions in the letters of the rulers of the world. What is more spirited, more skilful, more concise, more penetrating than either of these? What is more appropriate to a judicious orator, especially an ambassador or a royal counsellor? Every excellent pragmatic must become thoroughly conversant with them.⁹⁶

These notes give a vivid sense of how Harvey treats virtuoso oratory as an integral part of strategy, comparable with military tactics in its ability to influence the outcome of political confrontation (even though elsewhere, as we shall see, he made serious efforts to master Roman writings on warfare tactics and battle formation). We should not find this surprising. Livy and Machiavelli had both stressed the vital importance of effective rhetoric to generals as well as to statesmen; and Harvey had given much of his career to the study of oratory.

Between these two extremes, Harvey appears ultimately to settle for *aphoristic* history, as crucially policy-forming for the politician; and this is consistent with his commitment to Bodin, Daneau, Hotman and others, associated with contemporary moves to reform the legal systems and political structures of modern states using ancient models. It is in a book of aphoristic sayings from Demosthenes that Harvey quotes Bodin on history; and it is at the end of that work that he cross-refers (evidently for something like the first time) to "Daneau's very new aphorisms", as appropriate reading at this point.⁹⁷ Annotating the introductory letter (addressed to Henry VIII) in his copy of Morysine's translation of Frontinus' *Stratagems*, Harvey writes: "Aphorisms and examples will speedily make you great and admirable. Of longer discourses and histories there is no end. They tire the body and confuse the intellect and the memory".⁹⁸ The passage against which this is written is also marked with Harvey's

⁹⁶ Transcription by Walter Colman. Copy in Worcester College, Oxford. See also Sir Thomas Smith's library list, Queen's College, Cambridge: R. Simpson, *Sir Thomas Smith's Booklists, 1566 and 1576* (Warburg Institute Surveys and Texts, xv, forthcoming). This copy of Livy's *Conciones* has Thomas Smith's signature on its title-page ("Thomas Smyth"), that is, Smith junior. Which suggests that the two might well have had the two Livy texts together (on the book-wheel!) during their reading.

⁹⁷ Transcription by Walter Colman; Harvey's copy of Demosthenes, *Gnomologiae*, sig. o3^r (now in Brit. Lib.).

⁹⁸ Harvey's Frontinus, at present in the Houghton Lib., Harvard, sig. a vi^r. Another marginal note here refers the reader to Aphthonius' *Progymnasmata* for similar aphorisms.

"martial" sign (♂), and the "aphorisms" in question are pointedly triggering to action (and peculiarly appropriate as usual to the "war party" among whom Harvey sought his patrons):

Whan tyme byddeth spende, sparynge is great waste. Loue is lewdenesse, whan tyme biddeth hate. Peace is to be refused, wha[n] tyme forceth men to warre. Wherefore, I haue besydes this my tra[n]slation [of Frontinus], in an other tryfle of myn, exhorted al my contrey me[n], peace laid aside, to prepare for warre.

At the bottom of page 271 of the Livy, on a page which Harvey heads in his "military" vein, "The Romanes neuer so matched & tamed, as bie Annibal a long time", we find a marginal note in his diplomatic mode: "No repose or delay here. No notes can equal the author himself, not even the sharpest discourses or aphorisms. He is still sharper himself, and deeper". Over the page this allusion to Daneau and Machiavelli is filled out as follows:

One who wants political axioms here should read Daneau's political axioms from Polybius, or rather should himself collect more prudent ones, and more appropriate to civil and military discipline, from political principles. For example: Justinian's rules of law, Vegetius' rules of war, Isocrates' rules of civilized life. Or like the political principles of Aristotle, which come from Herodotus, Thucydides, Xenophon, Homer and others. There is no specialist in political, or economic, or ethical axioms drawn from histories and poems to match Aristotle in his Politics, Oeconomics, Ethics. But how much greater would he have been had he known histories that were so much greater — especially Roman history? Machiavelli certainly outdid Aristotle in observation of this above all, though he had a weaker foundation in technical rules and philosophical principles. Hence I generally prefer Aristotle's rules, Machiavelli's examples.⁹⁹

Harvey's search for first principles of politics — at once derived from the Aristotelian belief that the highest form of science consists in the provision of such principles, and connected with the effort of so many of his contemporaries to crystallize the most powerful ideas they had about law, morality and politics into adages, emblems and *regulae iuris* — is not surprising.¹⁰⁰ What may surprise us, though — and here the need to study the habits of actual readers emerges — is the nature of the source where he looks for them. Harvey boasts of his knowledge of Aristotle and Machiavelli. But he finds actual guidance in formulating aphorisms in the much humbler little collection of political axioms by the Calvinist pastor and theologian Lambert Daneau.

The political aphorisms in Daneau appropriate to this episode in Livy (the fall of Saguntum and the subsequent Roman embassy to

⁹⁹ Harvey's Livy, p. 273.

¹⁰⁰ See P. Stein, *Regulae iuris* (Edinburgh, 1966).

Carthage) are indeed to be found among those drawn from Polybius (since we recall that Daneau only collects aphorisms from Livy's first decade). There we find aphorisms like the following, succinctly drawing the lessons from the events:

Those who must wage a great war at a long distance must leave no hostile position that threatens them to the rear (that is why Hannibal took Saguntum)

Those who break public treaties first are starting wars in a hateful way (that is why Polybius condemns the Carthaginians)

In an empire consisting of several diverse peoples and provinces it is wisest to entrust the defence of one province to soldiers from another province, and vice versa. Thus they may be linked to one another by the performance of these reciprocal duties (thus Hannibal sent Spaniards to Africa, and moved Africans across to Spain).¹⁰¹

The focus of Harvey's (and presumably Preston's) interest in this episode, however, is the conduct of the legation sent by the Romans to Carthage after the fall of Saguntum, ostensibly to ask "whether Hannibal had attacked Saguntum with the authority of the government", but actually authorized formally to declare war on the Carthaginians. At the top and bottom of the page in which the Roman ambassadors and their Carthaginian hosts exchange speeches, Harvey writes:

The first bloom and vigour of Roman history, in the opinion of a couple of readers. Virtue regains strength after being wounded; it is the adamant basis for generous rivalry and excellence. Had Carthage not been Rome's bitter enemy, Rome would never have become the powerful mistress of the world. The harsher the ill fortune, the greater the favourable fortune in the end, where unvanquished virtue, the splendid contestant for victory, serves.

[Bottom of page] I want a politician who fixes the adamant basis on deeper foundations, and illustrates the best precepts with the best examples — and thus outdoes Aristotle himself in weight of principles, Machiavelli in choice of histories. I would like to begin where Machiavelli and Daneau leave off, and use the later counsels, laws, arms, judgements, magistracies, enterprises, industries and public directives of the Romans to correct the earlier ones skilfully and enlarge them diligently. Also to add the most supremely excellent ones from the other successful empires, kingdoms, republics of the world. Then to leave nothing unexamined or unexplained in the subtlest school doctors or deepest worldly pragmatics, which could improve or enlarge the principles.¹⁰²

In the middle of this page appears a virtuoso exchange between Quintus Fabius and the Carthaginians. The Carthaginian speaker elegantly finds Roman precedent for Carthage's and Hannibal's ac-

¹⁰¹ Lambert Daneau, *Politicorum aphorismorum silua, ex optimis . . . scriptoribus . . . collecta* (Leiden, 1620; first pubd. 1591), pp. 132-3.

¹⁰² Harvey's Livy, p. 275.

tions. Fabius' reply is blunt. He gathers his toga into a pouch and says, "Here we have for you either war or peace; take whichever you wish".

To this the senate shouted angrily that he might give them whichever he wished. Dropping the pouch of his toga as if to pour out its contents, he said that he gave them war. To this they answered that they accepted, and would wage it with the same courage as they had accepted it.

This straightforward declaration of war seemed more befitting the dignity of the Roman people than wrangling about the validity of the two treaties.¹⁰³

In the margin Harvey has written: "The extraordinarily honourable embassies of the Romans: to the Carthaginians, Spaniards, Gauls. No historian plays the ambassador or jurisconsult so vividly as Livy, here, above, below. It is most useful to a pragmatic to examine all these legations thoroughly".¹⁰⁴ And on the following page: "Roman ambassadors are grave and decisive; also more ready or prepared than the Spartans".¹⁰⁵

This emphasis on ambassadorial virtuosity is supported by another group of notes, which link performances by protagonists in the Livy with real-life stories of Elizabethan ambassadors "winning the day" with their feats of words.¹⁰⁶ By juxtaposing the vivid recent example with his printed text, Harvey stresses the "relevance" of the Livy reading to court diplomacy. The most vivid example comes in two marginal notes concerning "Doctor Dale".¹⁰⁷ On page 813 we find the story of Popilius' legation to Antiochus:

When Antiochus was four miles from Alexandria he was met by the Roman commissioners. He saluted them and held his hand out to Popilius. Popilius asked him first to read a document which he handed him. He did so, and said he would call and consult his ministers, whereupon Popilius with customary directness drew a circle around the king with the staff in his hand and said: "Give me your answer to the senate before you step out of this circle". The king was stunned by this peremptory order, but after hesitating a moment replied, "I will do as the senate bids". Popilius then deigned to give him his right hand, as a friend and ally.

Antiochus evacuated Egypt by the prescribed date, and the Romans sailed to Cyprus. From this base they expelled Antiochus' fleet, which already had conquered the Egyptian ships in battle. This embassy became renowned throughout the world. For it was obviously responsible for Antiochus' withdrawal from Egypt after the country already was in his power.

¹⁰³ Livy, xxi.

¹⁰⁴ Harvey's Livy, p. 275.

¹⁰⁵ *Ibid.*, p. 276.

¹⁰⁶ The reference to Harvey's discussions of diplomatic and political issues with the courtiers Edward Dyer and Edward Denny (quoted above, p. 38) comes on the page following this discussion of Roman diplomacy.

¹⁰⁷ See *D.N.B.*

This story has all the right ingredients: a crucial point in the war and a vital legation. Events turn on "customary directness" incisively mastering the situation and gaining the required response. It even has an unlikely outcome in military terms — gaining the verbal upper hand when in fact your adversary had the upper hand in terms of the battle, and *thus* beating him. In the right margin Harvey writes: "Popilius was an earnest and effective ambassador: having comparable authority even with the ruling house. [Later in English] One of doctor Dales great Examples: when he was Lord Ambassadors in Fraunce, & in Netherland".¹⁰⁸ At the bottom of the page Harvey relates Dale's preference for this story to his own success as an ambassador (also dealing with an adversary with "customary directness"):

Doctor Dale, Lord Ambassadors in Fraunce, & the Lowe Countries, was as resolute after his fashion, as Popilius himself: and stood upon as peremptorie termes with the French Kinge, the duke of Parma, & other mightie Princes, as the stowtest Romane euer did in the like cases. When the Earle of Darbie, & other Ambassadors respectiue quailed, he was allwaies in harte, absolute, & inuincible. The Prince of Parma was neuer so berded to his face, bie anie Ambassador.¹⁰⁹

At the very end of the Livy (after "finis indicis") we find out more about this bearding of the prince of Parma on the eve of the Armada:

Doctor Dale — the great pragmatic, and the most judicious ambassador I have known — used to say "Give me no. 1" when he wanted Justinian; "Give me no. 2" when he wanted his *Speculum iuris*;¹¹⁰ "Give me no. 3" when he wanted Livy. For he made more of these three authors than of all the rest, and he supplied himself with a manuscript notebook of secrets. William Spite (Speight?), procurator of the Court of Arches, and Dr. Dale's secretary in the Belgian legation to the duke of Parma, often told me this among other memorable doings of his. When the well-equipped Spanish fleet, commanded by the duke of Medina, was preparing to invade England in the near future, Dale was the only ambassador who dared to claim precedence over the duke of Parma when out walking, as the representative of a higher prince, his mistress; and wanted to precede, or refused to follow. When the duke of Parma fiercely uttered terrible threats, as though already thinking of the invasion of England, he laughed, and contemptuously replied with a non-verbal noise, as of lips smacking[!]. No other legate ventured anything like this against the brave Parma, in the midst of his fierce army. But the fearless doctor never showed dismay. In fact he showed open contempt for the vast army, mindful both of Livy's examples and of his kingdom, his fatherland, his rank. I have known few such readers of Livy, but the rarer, the more remarkable. Doctor Haddon and Doctor Wilson preferred Cicero and Caesar. But as ambassadors they were more elegant than effective; they were stiff in carrying out orders,

¹⁰⁸ Harvey's Livy, p. 813.

¹⁰⁹ *Ibid.*

¹¹⁰ See Stern, *Gabriel Harvey*, pp. 266-7.

and flaccid in grave transactions involving the queen's interest — compared with those two sharp pragmatics, Doctor Smith, the knight, and Doctor Wotton, the queen's counsellor. They applied themselves to Livy and Tacitus.

Here indeed is Livy's lesson of the highly wrought speech as crux and fulcrum on which events turn, in action.

Harvey's view of Livy's style — and his belief in its peculiar transparency as narrative — emerges most clearly from his note on the commentator Velcurio's effort to define the historical style. Velcurio writes for students learning to imitate. He explains Livy's style as "copious" and "grave", and emphasizes Livy's trick of weaving a special form of "period" "from several clauses or members, in such a way that it both expresses a given matter copiously and embraces and connects several matters in the same sentence".¹¹¹ This quality sets Livy off from other historians like Sallust and Caesar. Velcurio advises the student to cut Livy's "periods into their constituent parts" to see the historical style in detail, and gives rules for producing it in one's own prose (for example, "Very often in the historical period several nominatives and other cases are referred to a single verb, as if predicated"). And he makes clear that Livy's periodic prose makes him second only to Cicero as a teacher and model of eloquent Latin.¹¹²

Harvey disagrees. His comment reads:

Second to Cicero. Yet he is often ahead of him in the force of his aphorisms. Often, too, he describes persons, places, actions and things of great beauty more vividly. I have often found Quintilian a sort of composite of Cicero and Livy. Nor did any later Roman have a more florid style, more splendid aphorisms, or a more profound intellect, or a freer judgment, or finally more faith in his own intellect. Had there been no Livy there would have been no Fabius [Quintilian]; and had there been no Fabius, there would have been no Lorenzo Valla, whom I have felt to be the leader of so many modern critics.¹¹³

Harvey sees Livy as a master in a different sense than Velcurio does. Livy's prose presents people and events concretely, in three dimensions, offering an experience more cinematic than literary in our terms. Yet at the same time he offers exactly the sort of tuition one would expect to find in a master of rhetoric: invention, judgement and elocution, the basic parts of rhetoric, appear in the less explicit categories Harvey applies.¹¹⁴ Livy offers both explicit and implicit

¹¹¹ Harvey's Livy, sig. H 6^r.

¹¹² *Ibid.*, sig. I^r.

¹¹³ *Ibid.*

¹¹⁴ See Harvey's annotations in his copy of Livy, *Conciones*.

lessons: both the immediate vision of war *in actu* and the considered formulations needed by the statesman *in potentia*.

XII

"NO ONE DEPICTS SO GRAPHICALLY": SHARPENING THE IMAGES BY REPEATED READINGS

The best way to enhance our sense of how Harvey made Livy meaningful is to proceed from principles to applications. As Harvey notes approvingly: "Livy is certainly the best in Roman history. Each book is outstanding, in its kind. The variety of appealing facts is amazing. No historian either observes more seriously or depicts so graphically".¹¹⁵ But the graphic description requires insistent excavation: for how are the lessons of the ancient Roman Republic to be made applicable to a sixteenth-century monarchy?

In histories, the sayings and deeds of those considered wisest, strongest, most just by their fellows are praised. But what sort of politician speaks and acts, and to what end, and in what sort of state, and in what specific circumstances — these are vital too. Each acts in accordance with his estate, public or private, and no one binds his own hands. Many things were said and done with the greatest prudence in the Roman Republic, which it would be absurd to do in a kingdom and nowadays. Nothing is good that lacks the salt of judgement. Whatever is praiseworthy should also be appropriate.¹¹⁶

How did Livy's early Rome change contours, shadows and colours as Harvey inspected its crucially vivid narrative on successive occasions? Tackling the dense body of notes, with their persistent challenging of and intervention into the text presents a daunting and unmanageable task. But two selective analyses of his ways of reading will give some idea of how the reading altered according to the type of analysis he was using.

Towards the middle of book one Livy tells the story of the Horatii and the Curiatii. Romans and Albans, both descendants of the Trojans, have both stolen one another's cattle, refused restitution, and levelled ultimatums. They confront one another in order of battle but decide, given the danger posed by the Etruscans to both parties, to avoid a full-scale combat and arrange a trial by battle in its place. Each army has a set of triplets, the Roman Horatii and the Alban

¹¹⁵ Harvey's Livy, sig. a3' (at end of preface).

¹¹⁶ This is part of a long note on the first blank page of the volume. The note ends (immediately after the passage quoted): "G.H. 1580". We may therefore take this to be the sentiment behind the "reading" of Livy which Harvey undertook at the beginning of his period of serious political employment (when he was publicly appointed to serve Leicester, whatever his status thereafter).

Curiatii, that can represent it. A treaty is made and solemnized with elaborate ritual. The brothers fight. Two Romans fall, but the third, unhurt, runs away, separates the three Albans and kills them one by one. Horatius, returning in triumph to the city, meets his sister, who had been engaged to one of the Curiatii. She cries out with sorrow on learning of her lover's death. Horatius promptly kills her, is found guilty of treason — and is then freed because of his popularity and his sister's lack of patriotism. Peace is made; but it does not last long.

The story has everything. Livy gives the details of disagreements among ancient scholars (over which set of triplets, the Roman or the Alban, had which family name). He lovingly describes Roman institutions, showing the "*fetial*" (priest) pluck and use the holy herb needed for making treaties and describing how the king and duumvirs declared and staged a trial for treason. Horatius provides an example of courage, patriotism and athletic prowess — but also of the errors to which too much zeal and courage can lead. Mettius the Alban provides an example of statesmanlike prudence and eloquent oratory. And Horatius' nameless sister makes a fine subject for a cautionary tale about the eternal female conflict between love and duty.

Harvey had ample exegetical resources on hand as he attacked this passage. The commentators in his Livy, Glareanus and Velcurio, both discussed book one, and though Glareanus left the Horatii alone, Velcurio treated them at length. He paraphrased every phrase or sentence that could possibly pose a difficulty. After the first two Horatii die, Livy describes the situation of the third: "*Forte is integer fuit, ut universis solus nequaquam par, sic adversus singulos ferox*" (The young man, though alone, was unhurt. No match for his three opponents together, he was yet confident of his ability to face them singly).¹¹⁷ Velcurio found a surprising amount of grist for his mill here, and ground it slow and small: "*Is*) that is Horace. *Integer*) that is, not wounded. *Vniversis*) that is, by the three together".¹¹⁸ And he went into technical detail of a more refined sort as well when it came to the legal aspects of Horatius' murder case, explaining at length why the taking of private revenge amounted to treason as well as parricide: "He punished his sister by private vengeance, when she should have been punished by the magistrate".

Harvey's notes on the passage show no interest whatever either in elementary problems of construing or in deeper ones of law and antiquities. Instead, he draws a political lesson:

¹¹⁷ Livy, i.25.7.

¹¹⁸ Harvey's Livy, sig. K 1'.

A splendid example of single combat. But this was a rash rather than a politically prudent way to reach a decision. It is in fact not politically prudent to entrust the general welfare to the virtue or fortune of so few. But this custom derived from the heroic virtue of a few of the ancients, by which, it seemed, all great questions should be decided.¹¹⁹

Harvey was hardly eccentric to suggest that this trial by combat had been imprudent and was not an example to emulate. Daneau also derived a similar axiom from the same passage: "It is always dangerous and often useless to entrust the general welfare (*summa rerum*) to a duel of two or more in a war. For the vanquished do not keep faith, and they do not suffer a great loss because of it".¹²⁰ And Machiavelli — who no doubt lurks, here as elsewhere, behind Daneau — had devoted three chapters of his *Discorsi sopra la prima deca di Tito Livio* to the story. He made it the pretext for a long and general argument that "one must never risk one's entire fortune with part of one's forces" (i.22). He drew from it the specific recommendation that one should not try to stop an enemy at one's border by confronting him with a small force (i.23). And he found in it food for reflection on the corruption of republics, arguing that while good citizens must be rewarded, it had been wrong simply to let Horatius go free after he had been fairly condemned for killing his sister (i.24).

Harvey begins from the prudential, "political" reading of Daneau and Machiavelli. Like them — and like his contemporary Justus Lipsius, whom he much admired — he wanted to extract and shrink to durable, concise, axiomatic form the pragmatic lessons of the text. But unlike them, he wanted to speculate about other matters as well. What captivated his imagination was less the imprudence of the custom Livy described than the reasons why it had been practised. He locates these in the ancients' belief in individual heroism, which made them think single combat an appropriate way to solve such problems. He may deplore the early Romans' heedlessness, but he applauds their chivalry. And his other notes show that what he — and Sidney — most appreciated in Livy was less the pragmatic maxims he could inspire than the heroic feats of arms that he so vividly described. Harvey's further notes on the passage include a Mars symbol; the exclamation "Vnicus Horatius" (Peerless Horatius); and, most revealing of all, a reflection on the feigned flight by which Horatius tricked his opponents into separating: "A strategic

¹¹⁹ *Ibid.*, p. 13.

¹²⁰ Daneau, *Politiconum aphorismorum silua*, p. 234.

flight. Not even Hercules could handle three, or even two of the most outstanding opponents in a fight".¹²¹

Here we see Harvey making clear what Livy meant to him: a treasury of military devices to be imitated and heroic battles to be savoured. This was what Harvey found in Roman history as he read about it elsewhere as well: for example, in his copy of Machiavelli's *Arte of Warre* (also now in Princeton) where one battle scene more than a page long is decorated with a Mars symbol at the end of every line. Harvey read not simply to reflect, boil down and imitate, but also to savour, speculate and admire. No wonder that the pleasures of the naked text outweighed the more refined rewards of learned commentary when he and Sidney did their reading. And they were not alone in their desire to view the Roman past as highly coloured and in three dimensions.¹²²

A further note on the slaying of Horatius' sister, however, takes quite a different tack:

See Augustine, *City of God*, iii.14, on the impiety of the war that the Romans waged against the Albans, and the victory that resulted from desire to rule; there he skilfully treats the Horatii and the Curiatii. [In darker ink] Cf. the biblical duel of David and Goliath. Also the heroic ones of Hercules and Cygnus in Hesiod, Achilles and Hector in Homer, Aeneas and Turnus in Virgil.¹²³

Here Harvey, reading by himself and later in life, refers to the eloquent chapter (iii.14) of *The City of God* in which Augustine ponders the Horatii and the Curiatii, condemns the murder of Horatius' sister and insists that the war itself deserved not honour but condemnation, like a gladiatorial combat. Harvey knew that Augustine's account amounted to an attack on the whole Roman heroic scheme of values: "See how, and how often, the divine wisdom of Augustine refutes the human prudence of Livy", he wrote early in book one.¹²⁴ He concluded that while each city had its virtues, the

¹²¹ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 13.

¹²² George Gascoyne, in the fourth dumb show of his *Iocasta* — a play performed at the Inner Temple — gives a re-enactment of the episode. In his version, Horatius is a "politique" of his own day; and by treating his retreat as tactical, Gascoyne produces a vivid and convincing version of the scene as a whole: "The third perceiuing, that he only remayned to withstand the force of iii. enimies, did politiquely runne aside: wherewith immediatly one of the iii. followed after him, and when he had drawen his enimie thus from his companie, hee turned against and slewe him" (We are grateful to Mac Pigman for this reference). Harvey owned a copy of *Iocasta*, now in the Bodleian Library; he does not comment on the interlude.

¹²³ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 13.

¹²⁴ *Ibid.*, p. 6: "Ecce quoties et quomodo humanam Livij prudentiam, divina redarguit Augustini Sapientia".

divine one was both "more securely built" and "more fortunate". The application of Augustine in the 1590s seems to undermine the "heroic" reading of Livy with Sidney in the mid-1570s, as if the older and wiser Harvey — his career expectations curtailed by the deaths of first Sidney and then Leicester, and the downfall of the aggressive Protestantism Sidney symbolized — had repented. Yet this simple (and sentimental) account does violence to the form and content of Harvey's note. He does not stop with Augustine. His final lines on the passage list heroic duels from Hesiod, Homer, Virgil — and the Old Testament — offering David and Goliath, perhaps, as an example of a vivid heroism that even Augustine could not condemn.

A second specific form of reading is exemplified in the third decade. When Velcurio tries to explain the use of history as the student should study it in Livy, he emphasizes the traditional virtue of providing worked examples of ethical and unethical conduct:

Examples of virtue and probity to be imitated, and of vices to be avoided, can easily be derived from Livy and from other historians. Thus hypotheses — that is, good, or bad, or intermediate examples of individuals — can properly be drawn from history; these are then considered and assigned to theses, that is, to their commonplaces (*loci communes*), and to the general principles of morality and other things.¹²⁵

Harvey, by contrast, annotating this passage, sticks to practicalities. Livy offers laws being made and institutions being created, not moral principles being tested:

No historian is as appropriate to a jurisconsult, or pragmatic, or legate, or royal counsellor, or finally a politician, as Livy, especially when accompanied by Tacitus, Suetonius, Frontinus; not to mention Valerius Maximus . . . When reading Livy, I often feel that I am reading the jurisconsults themselves — especially the Scaevolus, Sulpitii, Trebatii, Papiniani, that sort of very prudent ones.¹²⁶

Harvey's summary references through the third decade to Hannibal and the Romans consistently reveal these interests. They are single-minded in their concentration on leadership:

Fabius Max[imus] bie Warie, & cautelous proceeding, sumwhat cooled his [Hannibal's] heate: but liker slie Saturne, then gallant Jupiter, or braue Mars. Onlie Marcellus, & Scipio beat him at handstrokes the One in Italie, the other in Afrique.¹²⁷

Braue & redowted young Scipio: full of mightie courage, & valour.¹²⁸
[In Latin] Flavius, a shrewd pragmatic.¹²⁹

¹²⁵ *Ibid.*, sig. I 1'.

¹²⁶ *Ibid.*

¹²⁷ *Ibid.*, p. 294; Livy, xxii *ad int.*

¹²⁸ Harvey's Livy, p. 318; Livy, xxii.53.

¹²⁹ Harvey's Livy, p. 379; Livy, xxv.16.

Martius, a most braue & terrible knight, at a pinch. Which of the Heroical Worthyes cowlde haue dun more in the time?¹³⁰

[In Latin] Fabius, more adept in war; Martius in combat; Martius in action; Nero in forced marches; Scipio the most outstanding in all glorious military enterprises.¹³¹

[Scipio] As peerles fine, as matchles braue: a Mirrour of sweetest courtesie, & terriblest valour.¹³²

The purpose of these check-lists of heroic virtue is plain. Harvey saw — and no doubt took part in — debates about Carthaginian and Roman leaders. These lists of deeds and adjectives were the substantive preparation for such debate. Much as Erasmus compiled as his distinctive aid to eloquence a matchless list of two hundred and fifty ways to say "Thank you for the letter" in classical Latin, Harvey and Smith junior devoted much of their private effort to assembling material to be used in public.

But the third decade has a strong narrative line as well as individual stories of heroism. At the outset Hannibal's march on Rome seems irresistible, his victory inevitable. By the end his army is in disarray and Hannibal himself in despair, while Scipio returns to Rome in triumph. Harvey's marginal notes show how eagerly he followed Hannibal's progress and appreciated the Carthaginian general's "industry, and appalling vigilance".¹³³ Hannibal stalks onward, apparently implacable and unbeatable. But Harvey found more than virtue in Hannibal's feats of arms. He saw the seeds of Hannibal's eventual failure planted early in his campaign. In book twenty-two he fails to take the opportunity afforded by Cannae and attack Rome at once; in book twenty-three Hannibal winters in Capua, letting his army lose cohesion and morale; in book thirty he has become pitiable. Harvey remorselessly tracks each error of judgement. At book thirty he reflects: "Hannibal was beaten first in spirit; it is no surprise, then, that he was immediately beaten in the flesh as well. One's fortune corresponds to one's strength of mind and body".¹³⁴

Harvey finds a simple explanation for Hannibal's many related failures. He lacked the indomitable will needed to make the most of each opportunity as it occurred. "Occasion is only a point: now or never". "The sole essential for a great man is to seize the instant with great possibilities forcefully, with shocking power, and to play the

¹³⁰ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 391; *Livy*, xxv.37-9.

¹³¹ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 404; *Livy*, xxvi.20.

¹³² Harvey's *Livy*, p. 460; *Livy*, xxviii.18.

¹³³ Harvey's *Livy*, p. 296.

¹³⁴ *Ibid.*, p. 510.

powerful leader, when it is important to do so, with terrifying power".¹³⁵ Indecision, Machiavelli had long ago shown, was the most destructive of all errors in a ruler. Now Harvey read indecision into Livy's Hannibal.

The motives for this reading are not far to seek. In a sense it was over-determined, since it was inspired at least in part by Livy's own clues as well as by Harvey's immediate needs. But Harvey read the Carthaginian and Roman past above all in the terms of the English present. A rising member of the rising war party, he ached for action, like his patrons. In his copy of Withorne's translation of Machiavelli's *The Arte of Warre* (also annotated in 1580), against a passage in which Machiavelli advises the military leader not to make war in winter because

All the industrie that is vsed in the discipline of warre, is vsed for to bee prepared to fighte a field with thy enemie, because this is the ende, whereunto a Capitayne oughte to go or endeuour him selfe: For that the foughten field, geueth thee the warre wonne or loste.¹³⁶

Harvey has marked the word "ende", and writes exasperatedly in the margin: "This Ende, allmost at an ende, now a dais". By finding the reason for Hannibal's failure not in want of resources but in failure of will, he taught exactly the historical lesson that Walsingham and Leicester would have most liked Elizabeth — anxious always to avoid "the foughten field", and "the warre" (whether won or lost) — to learn. The alchemy of present needs turned Hannibal from a determined Fortinbras into a wavering Hamlet, in the margins if not in the text.

Harvey's transformation of Hannibal involved not only the explanation of a failure, but the development of sympathy for it. Harvey seems, as the third decade proceeds, to feel increasingly sorry for the fact that Hannibal did not carry out his aims. If he had only acted when he should have . . . "Maharbal's excellent advice [to march on Rome immediately after Cannae] could have made Hannibal as great as Alexander. But Hannibal, intent on lesser goods, lost his one chance for the greatest success. Now or never".¹³⁷ To find the moral he needed in the third decade, Harvey had to feel sympathy for the devil; to find in Livy's glorification of Rome the possibility of a

¹³⁵ *Ibid.*, p. 317. On Harvey's obsession with action, see N. Orsini, *Studi sul Rinascimento italiano in Inghilterra* (Florence, 1937), pp. 101-20; M. Praz, *The Flaming Heart* (New York, 1958), pp. 101-2.

¹³⁶ Harvey's copy of Machiavelli, *Arte of Warre*, fo. xciiij^r. Underlinings Harvey's.

¹³⁷ Harvey's Livy, p. 317.

counter-history that glorified Carthage. This he did with an ease and dexterity that one might not expect from a humanist.

XIII

HOW WELL DID HARVEY READ?

Harvey's reading of Livy would not earn the admiration of most modern classicists. He accepts Livy's accounts even when they are certainly erroneous — as in the case of Hannibal's disastrous delay at Capua, which the parallel account in Polybius shows to be Livy's own moralizing invention. But he also read Livy as Livy meant to be read — as a master rhetorician offering the history Cicero had called for in *De oratore*, a "work for orators" — and in doing so he praised exactly those qualities in Livy that had impressed his own classical model of the good rhetorician, Quintilian. Often he did pick up and work with small but important clues in Livy's text, clues that reveal Livy's own ambivalent assumptions. At one point, for example, reading Velcurio's comment on Romulus' and Numa's efforts to establish a religion at Rome, Harvey remarks that "There are many things that I think in passing as I read, which I hardly dare to write down".¹³⁸ Surely he referred here to Livy's own sense that the ancient Roman religion was literally false but socially useful, a tool to create social discipline — a sense that conflicts clearly, most modern readers would think, with Livy's efforts to proclaim his piety. Here and elsewhere Harvey's sheer skill and penetration are impressive.¹³⁹

Was Harvey deluded to think that flexible reading could take him to the top? Not necessarily. Another surviving piece of political "ephemera" suggests how much a part of a contemporary agenda his aspirations to annotate the margins of contemporary political practice may have been. A memorandum prepared by Robert Beale in 1592 for the private use of Edward Wotton, it explains in severely practical terms "The Office of a Councillor and Principall Secretarie to Her Majestie". It offers sage advice about how to define the privy council's agenda, avoid cabinet council "which does but cause iealousie and envie", and abbreviate the letters submitted to the council so that its members will at least have read a summary of the matters they must decide on. It also offers readings of many ancient historians: "Remember what Arrian saith in the life of Alexander . . . So likewise

¹³⁸ *Ibid.*, sig. I 3'.

¹³⁹ For Livy's intentions and reception in antiquity, see P. Walsh, *Livy* (Cambridge, 1970).

towards your fellow councillors behave yourself as Maecenas counselled Augustus . . . Be diligent. Remember the saying of Salust". Beale is quite unapologetic in his provision of these humanist axioms. Indeed he stresses in his conclusion that a good principal secretary must be a good reader of the classics: "By the readinge of histories you may observe the examples of times past, judging of their successe".¹⁴⁰

In his copy of *The Arte of Warre* Harvey summarizes the authors he would wish to have to hand in designing his own spurs to action in the field of war, including contemporary advisers after the manner of Beale's to Wotton:

Mie principal Autors for Warr, after much reading, & long consideration: Caesar, & Vegetius: Machiauel, & Gandino: Ranzouius, & Tetti: with owr Sutcliff, Sir Roger Williams, & Digges Stratoticos: all sharp, & sound masters of Warr. For y^e Art, Vegetius, Machiauel, & Sutcliff: for Stratagems, Gandino, & Ranzouius: for Fortification, Pyrotechnie, & engins, Tetti, & Digges: for y^e old Roman most worthie Discipline & Action, Caesar: for y^e new Spanish, & Inglish excellent Discipline & Action, Sir Ro: Williams. Autors enowgh; with y^e most cunning, & valorous practis in Esse. [Another time] Ow English militar Discipline, vnder General Norris, in y^e Dialogue, intituled, The Castle of Pollicy: Vnder y^e Earle of Leicester, In his owne Lawes, & Ordinances. The Spanish Discipline, vnder y^e Duke d'Alua, & y^e Prince of Parma, y^e best Discipline now in Esse, newly discoouered by Sir Roger Williams.¹⁴¹

We suggest that Harvey hoped his skills could win him a position exactly like Beale's, as a valued political adviser who combined practical experience and legal expertise with detailed study of the ancients. Harvey's mode of reading, in fact, was precisely the sort of serious political discourse that his authoritative contemporaries esteemed (and employed university men for). And we suggest that though Harvey did not succeed as completely as he hoped, his humanism was not at fault.¹⁴² Harvey's ability to read was perhaps

¹⁴⁰ Conyers Read, *M^r Secretary Walsingham and the Policy of Queen Elizabeth*, 3 vols. (Cambridge, Mass. and Oxford, 1925), i, appendix, pp. 423-43. Wotton also failed to achieve the office he expected, either in 1592 or three years later, when the matter was broached again: *ibid.*, i, p. 423.

¹⁴¹ Harvey's *Arte of Warre*, fo. Cix^r. The "newly discoouered by Sir Roger Williams" dates this to 1590-1.

¹⁴² In spite of Nashe's exuberant fantasies about Harvey's being chased back to Cambridge after an ignominiously brief employment with Leicester, these marginalia suggest a much more continuous toing-and-froing on Harvey's part between Cambridge and London, and constant contact with the political circle he claimed to advise in London. Spenser praises Harvey as a "looker-on" who "Ne fawnest for the fauour of the great . . . But freely doest", in a 1586 sonnet, written from his own minor-official post in Dublin: Moore Smith, *Gabriel Harvey's Marginalia*, p. 57, which confirms that Harvey held no official post, but nevertheless suggests that Harvey is intellectually active, in a desirably unconstrained fashion, in the circles of "onlookers" outside the immediate court circle.

his one uncontested asset; it took him far and yielded fascinating and contradictory visions of the Roman past.¹⁴³

If Harvey was ultimately proved wrong, and the fashion for employing this type of erudite facilitator in policy-making was short-lived, this may have more to do with political events than with the individual practitioners. Isaac Casaubon came to England in 1610. Although he shared Harvey's intense interest in reading history, and even his belief that the lessons of history could be reduced usefully to succinct axioms, he had no patience with learned advisors in the political arena.

Note [he wrote in one miscellany] that just as the "book-trained doctor" whom we read about in Galen and Aristotle and the "book-trained ship's pilot" are very dangerous, so absolutely is the "book-trained politician" (*politicus e libro*). The count of Essex's case is a tragic example of this. When this man, noble in other respects, was at a loss, a scholar who was later hanged gave him advice in Lucan's words. The tag was to this effect: you who have found no friends as a private individual will find many once you take arms. That verse doomed Essex.¹⁴⁴

So much for Henry Cuffe, one of the learned readers with whom we began. To Casaubon — who translated and commented on Polybius, but nourished no personal hope of advancement in court and political circles — the world of the late Elizabethan facilitator already belonged to a lost past which seemed alien and a little absurd, as well as tragic.

XIV

"READ WHAT YOU CAN THEN RIGHTLY CALL YOUR OWN": HARVEY'S PROGRAMME

Harvey's Livy and its companions on the wheel seem to show, when considered together, a coherent programme to master the whole world of learning and make it readily usable in political action. This is no coincidence or aberration; Harvey's intellectual ambitions in fact embraced the mapping of the whole intellectual landscape of his

¹⁴³ Possibly by 1590 the more "topical" works on the technology of war and military tactics were making Harvey's humanistic approach appear a little dated. See G. Parker's citation of Sir Roger Williams, also writing in 1590, saying that Alexander, Caesar, Scipio and Hannibal were doubtless "the worthiest and famous warriors that ever were", but that their example had little relevance to the modern age: G. Parker, *The Military Revolution: Military Innovation and the Rise of the West, 1500-1800* (Cambridge, 1988).

¹⁴⁴ Bodleian Lib., MS. Casaubon 28, fo. 127r. For Casaubon's instructions on deriving axioms from classical historians (specifically Tacitus), see MS. Casaubon 24, fo. 125r. For Casaubon and Polybius, see A. Momigliano, "Polybius' Reappearance in Western Europe", in his *Essays in Ancient and Modern Historiography* (Oxford, 1977), pp. 79-98.

time. No single book offered more data between two covers than that great information-retrieval tool of the sixteenth century, Simler's epitome of Conrad Gesner's *Bibliotheca*. This vast, alphabetically ordered compendium gave brief notices, bibliographies and judgments of the writings of all serious authors, ancient and modern alike, from Aaron Bataleus to Zyzymus. Harvey read it with care, marking the margins continuously with *signes de renvoi* and occasionally calling attention to his special favourites among the authors listed: notably Rudolph Agricola and Lorenzo Valla. After the preface he entered a programmatic note that reveals as explicitly as anything he ever wrote the contours of his intellectual enterprise as a whole:

One needs Gesner's great *Bibliotheca*, especially for summaries and critiques of different authors. These are most important in reading classic and many other authors thoroughly and with the proper attentiveness and utility. Certainly any philologist must find it helpful to have at hand succinct summaries and intelligent critiques of all outstanding writers, and especially those who are classics or of outstanding importance in their field. This is the most important skill of modern criticism, and the highest vocation of the knowledgeable discourses. This is how important it is to be a suggestive summarizer and a sharp critic. But note, I use Hesiod's distinction: "half is more than the whole". One must select the best material from the best writers; the most appropriate material from individuals; the most active, from the best and most appropriate writers . . . Read what you can then rightly call your own. The sum of Socrates's wisdom is this: "Think and act". "Experience outdoes inexperience". Everything rests on art and virtue.

Gabriel Harvey. 1584.¹⁴⁵

Thus critical reading, skilful annotation and active appropriation emerge as the central skills, not just of the student of history, but of the intellectual *tout court*. Reading always leads to action — but only proper reading, methodical reading — reading in the manner of a Gabriel Harvey.

And here we must emphasize again that Harvey's ideals and methods were not idiosyncratic or whimsical. No text by Philip Sidney has provoked more debate than his letter to his brother of 15 October 1580 on the reading of history. Some have seen this as a manifesto of Sidney's commitment to the modern, continental style of reading history — a reasonable inference given his praise of Tacitus and emphasis on the technical study of chronology. Others have taken it as a criticism of contemporary over-emphasis on the theory of historiography — also a reasonable inference given his remark that "For the method of writing Historie, Bodin hath written at large,

¹⁴⁵ Moore Smith, *Gabriel Harvey's Marginalia*, pp. 125-6; our thanks to the Houghton Library, Harvard, for letting us inspect the Gesner (now in that collection).

yow may reade him and gather out of many wordes some matter". In fact, however, a comparison between this document and Harvey's Livy makes clear that Sidney was purveying, not his own wit, but Harvey's method, to his brother. As Harvey had insisted in practice, Sidney insisted in theory on the variety of roles each historian plays — and in which he must be appreciated by the competent reader: "An Orator in making excellent orations *out of the substance of the matter* [e re nata] which are to be marked, but marked with the note of rhetorically remembrances; a Poet in painting forth the effects, the motions, the whisperings of the people". Like Harvey, Sidney saw the chief task of the intellectual, ancient or modern, as serving as "a Discourser, which name I give to who soever speakes *not just concerning what happened, but about the qualities and circumstances of what happened* [non simpliciter de facto, sed de qualitatibus et circumstantiis facti]"¹⁴⁶ — a definition that embraces both what Harvey saw in Livy and what he hoped himself to become. And even in taking an independent attitude towards Bodin, Sidney did not deviate from, but continued, Harvey's brand of humanist scholarship. Harvey's tactics as a reader, in short, yield us a general insight into the ways in which some late sixteenth-century intellectuals tried to cope with the flood of information that the presses poured over them.

Just occasionally, the carefully-weighted political inferences in which Harvey took such pride are interrupted by a more emotional response of the kind we tend to like now — though even then the emotion was directed not at the book he read, but at the act of reading it. "Why am I delaying so?" he exclaims at the beginning of book six, where he thought that Livy's detailed account of antiquities left off and a more strictly political narrative began. He urged himself simply to read, and not to write anything down:

This vulgar bad habit of writing often makes readers dilatory and usually makes actors cowardly. The followers of Socrates were wiser: they preferred teachings that were unwritten, spoken, preserved by memorization. "Take your hand from the picture", runs the old saying. "Take the pen from your hand", so runs my saying now.¹⁴⁷

Here, for once, Harvey, as reader, offers a response of the intensity the modern reader hopes for. Our challenge in the present exploration

¹⁴⁶ See above, p. 36, for Harvey's record of precisely such a concern on Sidney's part when reading Livy's third decade: "[In reading,] our consideration was chiefly directed at the forms of states, the conditions of persons, and the qualities of actions". On Sidney's letter, see E. Story Donno, "Old Mouse-Eaten Records: History in Sidney's *Apology*", *Studies in Philology*, lxxii (1975), pp. 275-98.

¹⁴⁷ Harvey's Livy, p. 149.

of Renaissance reading has been to find a position which will allow us not to prefer such occasional exclamations to Harvey's self-consciously measured aphorisms, but to make both together a part of the reconstruction of an entirely unfamiliar brand of engagement with experience and intellectual history.¹⁴⁸

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¹⁴⁸ Here as in other areas the methods used by early modern historians are more primitive than those that have long been used by students of earlier periods. The need to study literature, reading, the making of books and the interpretation of texts in conjunction was understood by biblical and classical scholars of the eighteenth century; see F. A. Wolf, *Prolegomena to Homer* [1795], trans. A. Grafton *et al.* (Princeton, 1985). Medievalists have assimilated the same lesson without undue difficulty or resistance; see, for example, B. Stock, *The Implications of Literacy* (Princeton, 1983), with its significant subtitle: *Written Language and Models of Interpretation in the Eleventh and Twelfth Centuries*. Even the best-informed historians of the book in the early modern period have taken a narrower view of their task; see R. Chartier, "Intellectual History or Sociocultural History? The French Trajectories", in D. LaCapra and S. L. Kaplan (eds.), *Modern European Intellectual History: Reappraisals and New Perspectives* (Ithaca and London, 1982), pp. 38-9, for a programmatic statement exemplary in both its strengths and its limitations.